

CIS Oracle MySQL Community Server 9.7 Benchmark

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Overview

All CIS Benchmarks™ (Benchmarks) focus on technical configuration settings used to maintain and/or increase the security of the addressed technology, and they should be used in **conjunction** with other essential cyber hygiene tasks like:

- Monitoring the base operating system and applications for vulnerabilities and quickly updating with the latest security patches.
- End-point protection (Antivirus software, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), etc.).
- Logging and monitoring user and system activity.

In the end, the Benchmarks are designed to be a key **component** of a comprehensive cybersecurity program.

Important Usage Information

All Benchmarks are available free for non-commercial use from the [CIS Website](#). They can be used to manually assess and remediate systems and applications. In lieu of manual assessment and remediation, there are several tools available to assist with assessment:

- [CIS Configuration Assessment Tool \(CIS-CAT® Pro Assessor\)](#)
- [CIS Benchmarks™ Certified 3rd Party Tooling](#)

These tools make the hardening process much more scalable for large numbers of systems and applications.

NOTE: Some tooling focuses only on the Benchmark Recommendations that can be fully automated (skipping ones marked **Manual**). It is important that **ALL** Recommendations (**Automated** and **Manual**) be addressed since all are important for properly securing systems and are typically in scope for audits.

Key Stakeholders

Cybersecurity is a collaborative effort, and cross functional cooperation is imperative within an organization to discuss, test, and deploy Benchmarks in an effective and efficient way. The Benchmarks are developed to be best practice configuration guidelines applicable to a wide range of use cases. In some organizations, exceptions to specific Recommendations will be needed, and this team should work to prioritize the problematic Recommendations based on several factors like risk, time, cost, and labor. These exceptions should be properly categorized and documented for auditing purposes.

Apply the Correct Version of a Benchmark

Benchmarks are developed and tested for a specific set of products and versions and applying an incorrect Benchmark to a system can cause the resulting pass/fail score to be incorrect. This is due to the assessment of settings that do not apply to the target systems. To assure the correct Benchmark is being assessed:

- **Deploy the Benchmark applicable to the way settings are managed in the environment:** An example of this is the Microsoft Windows family of Benchmarks, which have separate Benchmarks for Group Policy, Intune, and Stand-alone systems based upon how system management is deployed. Applying the wrong Benchmark in this case will give invalid results.
- **Use the most recent version of a Benchmark:** This is true for all Benchmarks, but especially true for cloud technologies. Cloud technologies change frequently and using an older version of a Benchmark may have invalid methods for auditing and remediation.

Exceptions

The guidance items in the Benchmarks are called recommendations and not requirements, and exceptions to some of them are expected and acceptable. The Benchmarks strive to be a secure baseline, or starting point, for a specific technology, with known issues identified during Benchmark development are documented in the Impact section of each Recommendation. In addition, organizational, system specific requirements, or local site policy may require changes as well, or an exception to a Recommendation or group of Recommendations (e.g. A Benchmark could Recommend that a Web server not be installed on the system, but if a system's primary purpose is to function as a Webserver, there should be a documented exception to this Recommendation for that specific server).

In the end, exceptions to some Benchmark Recommendations are common and acceptable, and should be handled as follows:

- The reasons for the exception should be reviewed cross-functionally and be well documented for audit purposes.
- A plan should be developed for mitigating, or eliminating, the exception in the future, if applicable.
- If the organization decides to accept the risk of this exception (not work toward mitigation or elimination), this should be documented for audit purposes.

It is the responsibility of the organization to determine their overall security policy, and which settings are applicable to their unique needs based on the overall risk profile for the organization.

Remediation

CIS has developed [Build Kits](#) for many technologies to assist in the automation of hardening systems. Build Kits are designed to correspond to Benchmark's "Remediation" section, which provides the manual remediation steps necessary to make that Recommendation compliant to the Benchmark.

When remediating systems (changing configuration settings on deployed systems as per the Benchmark's Recommendations), please approach this with caution and test thoroughly.

The following is a reasonable remediation approach to follow:

- CIS Build Kits, or internally developed remediation methods should never be applied to production systems without proper testing.
- Proper testing consists of the following:
 - Understand the configuration (including installed applications) of the targeted systems. Various parts of the organization may need different configurations (e.g., software developers vs standard office workers).
 - Read the Impact section of the given Recommendation to help determine if there might be an issue with the targeted systems.
 - Test the configuration changes with representative lab system(s). If issues arise during testing, they can be resolved prior to deploying to any production systems.
 - When testing is complete, initially deploy to a small sub-set of production systems and monitor closely for issues. If there are issues, they can be resolved prior to deploying more broadly.
 - When the initial deployment above is completed successfully, iteratively deploy to additional systems and monitor closely for issues. Repeat this process until the full deployment is complete.

Summary

Using the Benchmarks Certified tools, working as a team with key stakeholders, being selective with exceptions, and being careful with remediation deployment, it is possible to harden large numbers of deployed systems in a cost effective, efficient, and safe manner.

NOTE: As previously stated, the PDF versions of the CIS Benchmarks™ are available for free, non-commercial use on the [CIS Website](#). All other formats of the CIS Benchmarks™ (MS Word, Excel, and [Build Kits](#)) are available for CIS [SecureSuite](#)® members.

CIS-CAT® Pro is also available to CIS [SecureSuite](#)® members.

Target Technology Details

This document, CIS Oracle MySQL Community Server 9.7 Benchmark, provides prescriptive guidance for establishing a secure configuration posture for MySQL Community Server 9.7. This guide was tested against MySQL Community Server 9.7 running on Oracle Linux, but applies to other Linux distributions as well. To obtain the latest version of this guide, please visit <http://benchmarks.cisecurity.org>. If you have questions, comments, or have identified ways to improve this guide, please write us at feedback@cisecurity.org.

Intended Audience

This document is intended for system and application administrators, security specialists, auditors, help desk, and platform deployment personnel who plan to develop, deploy, assess, or secure solutions that incorporate Oracle MySQL Community Server 9.7.

Consensus Guidance

This CIS Benchmark™ was created using a consensus review process comprised of a global community of subject matter experts. The process combines real world experience with data-based information to create technology specific guidance to assist users to secure their environments. Consensus participants provide perspective from a diverse set of backgrounds including consulting, software development, audit and compliance, security research, operations, government, and legal.

Each CIS Benchmark undergoes two phases of consensus review. The first phase occurs during initial Benchmark development. During this phase, subject matter experts convene to discuss, create, and test working drafts of the Benchmark. This discussion occurs until consensus has been reached on Benchmark recommendations. The second phase begins after the Benchmark has been published. During this phase, all feedback provided by the Internet community is reviewed by the consensus team for incorporation in the Benchmark. If you are interested in participating in the consensus process, please visit <https://workbench.cisecurity.org/>.

Typographical Conventions

The following typographical conventions are used throughout this guide:

Convention	Meaning
<code>Stylized Monospace font</code>	Used for blocks of code, command, and script examples. Text should be interpreted exactly as presented.
<code>Monospace font</code>	Used for inline code, commands, UI/Menu selections or examples. Text should be interpreted exactly as presented.
<code><Monospace font in brackets></code>	Text set in angle brackets denote a variable requiring substitution for a real value.
<i>Italic font</i>	Used to reference other relevant settings, CIS Benchmarks and/or Benchmark Communities. Also, used to denote the title of a book, article, or other publication.
Bold font	Additional information or caveats things like Notes , Warnings , or Cautions (usually just the word itself and the rest of the text normal).

Recommendation Definitions

The following defines the various components included in a CIS recommendation as applicable. If any of the components are not applicable it will be noted, or the component will not be included in the recommendation.

Title

Concise description for the recommendation's intended configuration.

Assessment Status

An assessment status is included for every recommendation. The assessment status indicates whether the given recommendation can be automated or requires manual steps to implement. Both statuses are equally important and are determined and supported as defined below:

Automated

Represents recommendations for which assessment of a technical control can be fully automated and validated to a pass/fail state. Recommendations will include the necessary information to implement automation.

Manual

Represents recommendations for which assessment of a technical control cannot be fully automated and requires all or some manual steps to validate that the configured state is set as expected. The expected state can vary depending on the environment.

Profile

A collection of recommendations for securing a technology or a supporting platform. Most benchmarks include at least a Level 1 and Level 2 Profile. Level 2 extends Level 1 recommendations and is not a standalone profile. The Profile Definitions section in the benchmark provides the definitions as they pertain to the recommendations included for the technology.

Description

Detailed information pertaining to the setting with which the recommendation is concerned. In some cases, the description will include the recommended value.

Rationale Statement

Detailed reasoning for the recommendation to provide the user a clear and concise understanding on the importance of the recommendation.

Impact Statement

Any security, functionality, or operational consequences that can result from following the recommendation.

Audit Procedure

Systematic instructions for determining if the target system complies with the recommendation.

Remediation Procedure

Systematic instructions for applying recommendations to the target system to bring it into compliance according to the recommendation.

Default Value

Default value for the given setting in this recommendation, if known. If not known, either not configured or not defined will be applied.

References

Additional documentation relative to the recommendation.

CIS Critical Security Controls® (CIS Controls®)

The mapping between a recommendation and the CIS Controls is organized by CIS Controls version, Safeguard, and Implementation Group (IG). The Benchmark in its entirety addresses the CIS Controls safeguards of (v7) "5.1 - Establish Secure Configurations" and (v8) "4.1 - Establish and Maintain a Secure Configuration Process" so individual recommendations will not be mapped to these safeguards.

Additional Information

Supplementary information that does not correspond to any other field but may be useful to the user.

Profile Definitions

The following configuration profiles are defined by this Benchmark:

- **Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux**

Items in this profile apply to MySQL Community Server 9.7 running on Linux and intend to:

- be practical and prudent;
- provide a clear security benefit; and
- not inhibit the utility of the technology beyond acceptable means.

- **Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux**

This profile extends the "Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux" profile. Items in this profile apply to MySQL Community Server 9.7 running on Linux and exhibit one or more of the following characteristics:

- are intended for environments or use cases where security is paramount
- acts as defense in depth measure
- may negatively inhibit the utility or performance of the technology.

- **Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS**

Items in this profile apply to MySQL Community Server 9.7 and intend to:

- be practical and prudent;
- provide a clear security benefit; and
- not inhibit the utility of the technology beyond acceptable means.

Note: the intent of this profile is to include checks that can be assessed by remotely connecting to a MySQL RDBMS. Therefore, file system-related checks are not contained in this profile.

- **Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS**

This profile extends the "Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS" profile. Items in this profile apply to MySQL Community Server 9.7 and exhibit one or more of the following characteristics:

- are intended for environments or use cases where security is paramount
- acts as defense in depth measure
- may negatively inhibit the utility or performance of the technology.

Note: the intent of this profile is to include checks that can be assessed by remotely connecting to a MySQL RDBMS. Therefore, file system-related checks are not contained in this profile.

Acknowledgements

This Benchmark exemplifies the great things a community of users, vendors, and subject matter experts can accomplish through consensus collaboration. The CIS community thanks the entire consensus team with special recognition to the following individuals who contributed greatly to the creation of this guide:

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Recommendations

1 Operating System Level Configuration

This section contains recommendations related to the Operating System on which the MySQL database server is running.

1.1 Place Databases on Non-System Partitions (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

It is generally accepted that host operating systems should include different file system partitions for different purposes. One set of file systems is typically called system partitions, and these are generally reserved for host system/application operation. The other set of file systems is typically called "non-system partitions", and such locations are generally reserved for storing data.

Rationale:

Moving the database off the system partition will reduce the probability of denial of service caused by exhaustion of available disk space to the operating system.

Impact:

Moving database files and directories to a non-system partition may be difficult depending on whether there was only a single partition when the operating system was set up and whether there are additional non-system partitions available.

Audit:

Execute the following steps to assess this recommendation:

- Obtain the location of the **datadir** and other MySQL database files by executing the following SQL statement:

```
SELECT VARIABLE_NAME, VARIABLE_VALUE
FROM performance_schema.global_variables
WHERE (VARIABLE_NAME LIKE '%dir' or VARIABLE_NAME LIKE '%file') and
(VARIABLE_NAME NOT LIKE '%core%'
AND VARIABLE_NAME <> 'local_infile' AND VARIABLE_NAME <>
'relay_log_info_file') order by
VARIABLE_NAME;
```

- Using the value returned for the **datadir**, and other results from the above query, execute the following in a system terminal:

```
df -h <directory>
```

The output returned from the **df** command above should not include root (/), **/var**, or **/usr**.

Remediation:

Perform the following steps to remediate this setting for the **datadir**:

1. Backup the database.
2. Choose a non-system partition **new location** for MySQL data.
3. Stop **mysqld** using a command like: **service mysql stop**.
4. Copy the data using a command like: **cp -rp<datadir Value> <new Location>**.
5. Set the **datadir** location to the **new location** in the MySQL configuration file.
6. Start **mysqld** using a command like:

```
service mysql start
```

Note: On some Linux distributions you may need to additionally modify **apparmor** settings. For example, on an Ubuntu 14.04.1 system edit the file **/etc/apparmor.d/usr.sbin.mysqld** so that the **datadir** access is appropriate. The original might look like this:

```
# Allow data dir access
/var/lib/mysql/ r,
/var/lib/mysql/** rwk,
```

Alter those two paths to be the new location you chose above. For example, if that new location were **/media/mysql**, then the **/etc/apparmor.d/usr.sbin.mysqld** file should include something like this:

```
# Allow data dir access
/media/mysql/ r,
/media/mysql/** rwk,
```

Default Value:

Not Applicable.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/mysql-secure-deployment-guide/9.7/en/secure-deployment-permissions.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.12 Segment Data Processing and Storage Based on Sensitivity Segment data processing and storage based on the sensitivity of the data. Do not process sensitive data on enterprise assets intended for lower sensitivity data.		●	●

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v7	<u>2.10 Physically or Logically Segregate High Risk Applications</u> Physically or logically segregated systems should be used to isolate and run software that is required for business operations but incur higher risk for the organization.			●

1.2 Use Dedicated Least Privileged Account for MySQL Daemon/Service (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

As with any service installed on a host, it can be provided with its own user context. Providing a dedicated user to the service provides the ability to precisely constrain the service within the larger host context.

Rationale:

Utilizing a least privilege account for MySQL to execute as needed may reduce the impact of a MySQL-born vulnerability. A restricted account will be unable to access resources unrelated to MySQL, such as operating system configurations.

Audit:

Execute the following command at a terminal prompt to assess this recommendation:

```
ps -ef | egrep "^mysql.*$"
```

If no lines are returned, then this is a fail.

Note: It is assumed that the MySQL user is `mysql`. Additionally, you may consider running `sudo -l` as the MySQL user or to check the sudoers file.

Remediation:

Create a user which is only used for running MySQL and directly related processes. This user must not have administrative rights to the system. Additionally, it's best to avoid providing shell access to such an account.

Shell access can be removed using the following command at a terminal prompt:

```
/usr/sbin/groupadd -g 27 -o -r mysql >/dev/null 2>&1 || :  
/usr/sbin/useradd -M -N -g mysql -o -r -d /var/lib/mysql -s /bin/false \  
-c "MySQL Server" -u 27 mysql >/dev/null 2>&1 || :
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/changing-mysql-user.html>
2. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/server-options.html#option_mysql_d_user

Additional Information:

The root user may be used to start the MySQL service on Linux/UNIX, but then it must be configured to drop privileges by specifying a service-specific user in the **my.cnf** or **my.ini** file.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>4.7 Manage Default Accounts on Enterprise Assets and Software</u> Manage default accounts on enterprise assets and software, such as root, administrator, and other pre-configured vendor accounts. Example implementations can include: disabling default accounts or making them unusable.			
v7	<u>14 Controlled Access Based on the Need to Know</u> Controlled Access Based on the Need to Know			

1.3 Disable MySQL Command History (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

On Linux/UNIX, the MySQL client and MySQL Shell log statements executed interactively to a history file. The default MySQL Client file is named `.mysql_history` in the user's home directory. The files are split by language and named `history.sql`, `history.js` and `history.py`. Most interactive commands run in the MySQL client application are saved to a history file. The MySQL command history should be disabled. By default, the MySQL Shell does not save history between sessions.

Rationale:

Disabling the MySQL Client and MySQL Shell command history reduces the probability of exposing sensitive information, such as passwords, encryption keys, or other sensitive data or information.

Audit:

Execute the following commands to assess this recommendation:

```
find /home -name ".mysql_history"
find /root -name ".mysql_history"
```

For MySQL Shell

```
ls -d .?*/.* | egrep history | grep mysql
```

For each file returned determine whether that file is symbolically linked to `/dev/null`.

Remediation:

For MySQL Client perform the following steps to remediate this setting:

1. Remove `.mysql_history` if it exists.
2. Use either of the techniques below to prevent it from being created again:
 - Set the `MYSQL_HISTFILE` environment variable to `/dev/null`. This will need to be placed in the shell's startup script.
 - Create `$HOME/.mysql_history` as a symbolic link to `/dev/null`.

```
> ln -s /dev/null $HOME/.mysql_history
```

Another way to prevent history from being recorded is to use the `--batch` option.

For MySQL Shell perform the following steps to remediate this setting:

1. Remove `$HOME/.mysqlsh/history.*` if files exist.
2. Use either of the techniques below to prevent it from being created again:

- Start shell and list show options using `\option -l`
- Set to no history using the command `\option --persist history.autoSave=1`

Default Value:

By default, the MySQL command history file is located in `$HOME/.mysql_history`.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/mysql-logging.html>
2. <https://bugs.mysql.com/bug.php?id=72158>
3. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/mysql-shell/9.7/en/mysql-shell-working-with-history.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.4 <u>Enforce Data Retention</u> Retain data according to the enterprise's data management process. Data retention must include both minimum and maximum timelines.			
v7	13.2 <u>Remove Sensitive Data or Systems Not Regularly Accessed by Organization</u> Remove sensitive data or systems not regularly accessed by the organization from the network. These systems shall only be used as stand alone systems (disconnected from the network) by the business unit needing to occasionally use the system or completely virtualized and powered off until needed.			

1.4 Verify That the MYSQL_PWD Environment Variable is Not in Use (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

MySQL can read a default database password from an environment variable called **MYSQL_PWD**. Avoiding use of this environment variable can better safeguard the confidentiality of MySQL credentials.

Rationale:

Using the **MYSQL_PWD** environment variable implies MySQL credentials are stored as clear text.

Audit:

To assess this recommendation, use the **/proc** file system to determine if **MYSQL_PWD** is currently set for any process:

```
grep MYSQL_PWD /proc/*/environ
```

This may return one entry for the process which is executing the grep command.

Remediation:

Check which users and/or scripts are setting **MYSQL_PWD** and change them to use a more secure method.

For unattended logins you should consider:

1. MySQL Configuration Editor
2. Different authentication methods (e.g., X509 certificate verification)
3. Use MySQL Enterprise LDAP plugin with Kerberos or SASL tokens.

Default Value:

Not set.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/environment-variables.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/mysql-config-editor.html>
3. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/pluggable-authentication.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.11 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data at Rest</u> Encrypt sensitive data at rest on servers, applications, and databases containing sensitive data. Storage-layer encryption, also known as server-side encryption, meets the minimum requirement of this Safeguard. Additional encryption methods may include application-layer encryption, also known as client-side encryption, where access to the data storage device(s) does not permit access to the plain-text data.			
v7	16.4 <u>Encrypt or Hash all Authentication Credentials</u> Encrypt or hash with a salt all authentication credentials when stored.			

1.5 Ensure Interactive Login is Disabled (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

When created, the MySQL user may have interactive access to the operating system, which means that the MySQL user could log into the host as any other user would.

Rationale:

Preventing the MySQL user from logging in interactively may reduce the impact of a compromised MySQL account. There is also more accountability, as accessing the operating system where the MySQL server lies will require the user's own account. Interactive access by the MySQL user is unnecessary and should be disabled.

Impact:

This setting will prevent the MySQL administrator from interactively logging into the operating system using the MySQL user. Instead, the administrator will need to log in using their own account.

Audit:

Execute the following command to assess this recommendation:

```
getent passwd mysql | egrep "^[^:]*[/bin|/false|/sbin|/nologin]$" 
```

Lack of output implies a fail.

Remediation:

Execute one of the following commands in a terminal:

```
usermod -s /bin/false mysql
```

Or

```
usermod -s /sbin/nologin mysql
```

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>5.4 Restrict Administrator Privileges to Dedicated Administrator Accounts</u> Restrict administrator privileges to dedicated administrator accounts on enterprise assets. Conduct general computing activities, such as internet browsing, email, and productivity suite use, from the user's primary, non-privileged account.			
v7	<u>4.3 Ensure the Use of Dedicated Administrative Accounts</u> Ensure that all users with administrative account access use a dedicated or secondary account for elevated activities. This account should only be used for administrative activities and not internet browsing, email, or similar activities.			

1.6 Verify That 'MYSQL_PWD' is Not Set in Users' Profiles (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

MySQL can read a default database password from an environment variable called **MYSQL_PWD**.

Rationale:

Use of the **MYSQL_PWD** environment variable implies MySQL credentials are stored as clear text. Avoiding use of this environment variable may increase assurance that the confidentiality of MySQL credentials is preserved.

Audit:

To assess this recommendation, check if **MYSQL_PWD** is set in login scripts using the following command:

```
grep MYSQL_PWD /home/*/.{bashrc,profile,bash_profile}
```

Remediation:

Check which users and/or scripts are setting **MYSQL_PWD** and change them to use a more secure method.

Default Value:

Not set.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/environment-variables.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.11 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data at Rest</u> Encrypt sensitive data at rest on servers, applications, and databases containing sensitive data. Storage-layer encryption, also known as server-side encryption, meets the minimum requirement of this Safeguard. Additional encryption methods may include application-layer encryption, also known as client-side encryption, where access to the data storage device(s) does not permit access to the plain-text data.			

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v7	16.4 <u>Encrypt or Hash all Authentication Credentials</u> Encrypt or hash with a salt all authentication credentials when stored.			

1.7 Ensure MySQL is Run Under a Sandbox Environment (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

Use of the `chroot()` system call at startup, Systemd with settings to achieve isolation, or Docker will put MySQL in a sandbox environment.

Rationale:

Running MySQL in a Sandbox environment may reduce the impact of a MySQL-born vulnerability by making portions of the file system inaccessible to the MySQL instance.

Impact:

Use of the `chroot` option somewhat limits `LOAD DATA INFILE` and `SELECT ... INTO OUTFILE`.

Audit:

Perform the following steps for each MySQL instance to assess this recommendation:

1. Execute the following SQL statement to determine the value of

`chroot`

```
cat /etc/mysql | egrep '(?<=^chroot=).+$'
```

The returned value should specify a valid path which differs from the `datadir`. No results implies 'chroot' is not in use.

2. Perform the following to check systemd:

```
systemctl status <mysqld>.service
```

If something other than `(root)` is listed beside the `PID`, e.g. `Main PID: <PID> (root)`, this is a pass. No results implies mysql is not managed by systemd.

3. Perform the following to determine if Docker is installed and a MySQL container is in use:
 1. To check for Docker installation, execute this command:

```
$ docker -v
```

If a message stating the version of Docker is shown, proceed to the next steps, otherwise no further action is needed as docker must be installed for mysql to be run in Docker.

2. To check if a mysql image exists in Docker run this command:

```
$ sudo docker images
```

REPOSITORY	TAG	IMAGE ID	CREATED	SIZE
mysql	latest	2fe463762680	1 week ago	514MB
mysql/mysql-server	latest	1504607f1ce7	2 weeks ago	401MB

If a mysql image is listed, proceed to the next steps, otherwise no further action is needed as a mysql image is required for mysql to be run in Docker.

3. Check if a mysql container is running:

```
$ sudo docker ps
```

CONTAINER ID	IMAGE	COMMAND	CREATED	STATUS	PORTS
0fc229e3df77	mysql	"docker..."	1 hour ago	Up 1 hour	
		0.0.0.0:3306->3306/tcp, mysql-server			:::3306->3306/tcp,
					33060/tcp

If a mysql container is listed then mysql is running in Docker and this is a pass.

If MySQL does not use **chroot**, **systemd**, or **docker**, this is a fail.

Remediation:

Perform one of the following steps to remediate this setting:

- Configure MySQL to use chroot:
 1. Choose a non-system partition **<chroot Location>** for MySQL
 2. Add **chroot=<chroot_Location>** to the **my.cnf** option file
- Configure MySQL to run under systemd:
 1. If mysql is managed by systemd and running, stop the service:

```
$ sudo systemctl stop <mysqld>.service
```

2. If a mysql user and group do not already exist, create them:

```
$ sudo groupadd mysql
$ sudo useradd -r -g mysql -s /bin/false mysql
```

3. Set the ownership of the base directory:

```
$ sudo chown -R mysql:mysql /usr/local/mysql/
```

4. Create or modify the `<mysqld>.service` file in `/lib/systemd/system` to include the following entries, if not already present:

```
[Unit]
Description=MySQL Server

[Install]
WantedBy=multi-user.target

[Service]
User=mysql
Group=mysql
```

5. If mysql was not already managed by systemd execute this command:

```
$ sudo systemctl daemon-reload
```

6. Start the MySQL server:

```
$ sudo systemctl start <mysqld>.service
```

7. If you would like mysql to automatically run at startup execute this command:

```
$ sudo systemctl enable <mysqld>.service
```

- Follow documentation in the references for standing up MySQL in a Docker container.

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/server-options.html#option_mysqld_chroot
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/docker-mysql-getting-started.html>
3. <https://hub.docker.com/r/mysql/mysql-server>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.12 Segment Data Processing and Storage Based on Sensitivity Segment data processing and storage based on the sensitivity of the data. Do not process sensitive data on enterprise assets intended for lower sensitivity data.			

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v7	2.10 <u>Physically or Logically Segregate High Risk Applications</u> Physically or logically segregated systems should be used to isolate and run software that is required for business operations but incur higher risk for the organization.			●

2 Installation and Planning

This section contains important considerations when deploying MySQL services to your production network and defining the configuration. The recommendations made herein are not scored from a benchmark perspective and generally align with best current practices as conveyed in most control frameworks.

The first consideration is related to the configuration options via the MySQL configuration file (e.g., `my.cnf`) and placing options under the proper section of `[mysqld]`. Options placed in the `my.cnf` configuration file should not be prefixed with a double dash (`--`). On Linux systems, `my.cnf` is located in the `/etc/` directory.

The second consideration is for an administrator to connect to a MySQL instance and change or add to the configuration options using the `SET PERSIST` command. This persists system variables in `mysqld-auto.cnf` which is located in the MySQL `datadir` by default. The file permissions on `mysqld-auto.cnf` are by default more restrictive than `my.cnf` (no world permissions).

Finally, configuration options can also be placed on the command line by modifying the MySQL startup script. The startup script is system dependent and based on your operating system.

2.1 Backup and Disaster Recovery

This section contains recommendations related to backup and recovery.

2.1.1 Backup Policy in Place (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

A backup policy should be in place.

Rationale:

Backing up MySQL databases, including **mysql**, will help ensure the availability of data in the event of an incident. Without backups, it might be hard to recover from an incident.

Audit:

Check with **crontab -l** if there is a backup schedule.

Remediation:

Create a backup policy and backup schedule.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	11.2 <u>Perform Automated Backups</u> Perform automated backups of in-scope enterprise assets. Run backups weekly, or more frequently, based on the sensitivity of the data.			
v7	10.1 <u>Ensure Regular Automated Back Ups</u> Ensure that all system data is automatically backed up on regular basis.			

2.1.2 Verify Backups are Good (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

Backups should be validated on a regular basis.

Rationale:

Verifying that backups are occurring appropriately will help ensure data availability in the event of an incident. Without a well-tested backup, it might be hard to recover from an incident if the backup procedure contains errors or doesn't include all required data.

Audit:

Check reports of backup validation tests.

Remediation:

Implement regular backup checks and document each check.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	11.5 Test Data Recovery Test backup recovery quarterly, or more frequently, for a sampling of in-scope enterprise assets.		●	●
v7	10.3 Test Data on Backup Media Test data integrity on backup media on a regular basis by performing a data restoration process to ensure that the backup is properly working.		●	●

2.1.3 Secure Backup Credentials (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

A database user with the least amount of privileges required to perform backup is needed. The credentials for this user should be protected. The password, certificate, and any other credentials should be protected.

Rationale:

When the backup credentials are not properly secured, then they might be abused to gain access to the server. The backup user needs an account with many privileges, so an attacker might potentially gain (almost) complete access to the server.

Audit:

Check permissions of files containing passwords and/or SSL keys.

Remediation:

Change file permissions.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.3 <u>Configure Data Access Control Lists</u> Configure data access control lists based on a user's need to know. Apply data access control lists, also known as access permissions, to local and remote file systems, databases, and applications.			
v8	11.3 <u>Protect Recovery Data</u> Protect recovery data with equivalent controls to the original data. Reference encryption or data separation, based on requirements.			
v7	10.4 <u>Ensure Protection of Backups</u> Ensure that backups are properly protected via physical security or encryption when they are stored, as well as when they are moved across the network. This includes remote backups and cloud services.			

2.1.4 The Backups Should be Properly Secured (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

The backup files will contain all data in the databases. File system permissions and/or encryption should be used to prevent unauthorized users from gaining access to the backups.

Rationale:

Backups should be considered sensitive information. If an unauthorized user can access backups, then they have access to all data in the database. This is true for unencrypted backups and for encrypted backups if the encryption key is stored along with the backup.

Audit:

Check who has access to the backup files.

- Are the files world readable (e.g., `rw-r--r--`)?
 - Are they stored in a world readable directory?
- Is the group MySQL and/or backup specific?
 - If not: the file and directory must not be group readable
- Are the backups stored offsite?
 - Who has access to the backups?
- Is a third party tool used to encrypt backups?
 - If yes, where is the encryption key stored?
 - If yes, does the encryption key consist of a guessable password?

Remediation:

Implement encryption, properly restrict file system permissions, protect and backup encryption keys.

- Restrict file and directory permissions so backup files are accessible only to the MySQL service account and designated backup users, for example:

```
$ chmod -R 640 <path_to_backups_directory>
$ chown -R mysql:<backup_group> <path_to_backups_directory>
```

- If a third-party encryption tool is used, ensure the encryption key is stored separately from the backup files.
- Ensure the encryption key or passphrase is strong and non-guessable.

- If backups are stored offsite, ensure access is limited to authorized personnel and the storage medium or transfer is itself encrypted.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	11.3 <u>Protect Recovery Data</u> Protect recovery data with equivalent controls to the original data. Reference encryption or data separation, based on requirements.			
v7	10.4 <u>Ensure Protection of Backups</u> Ensure that backups are properly protected via physical security or encryption when they are stored, as well as when they are moved across the network. This includes remote backups and cloud services.			

2.1.5 Point-in-Time Recovery (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

With binlogs it is possible to implement point-in-time recovery. This makes it possible to restore the changes between the last full backup and the point-in-time.

Enabling binlogs is not sufficient. The binlogs need to be backed up to separate media. The restore procedure should be created and tested. The data in the binlog files may contain sensitive information which needs to be stored in the proper location with restrictive permissions and may require encryption.

Rationale:

Using binlogs can reduce the amount of information lost when recovering from a backup.

Impact:

MySQL binary logs can grow large and consume significant disk space, so an automatic purge or retention policy should be configured.

Audit:

Check if binlogs are enabled and if there is a restore procedure. Check to see if `--binlog-expire-logs-seconds` is set.

```
SELECT VARIABLE_NAME, VARIABLE_VALUE, 'BINLOG - Log Expiration' as Note
FROM performance_schema.global_variables where variable_name =
'binlog_expire_logs_seconds';
```

Ensure this value is not set to `0`.

Note: Consider implementing MySQL Enterprise Backup which includes support for at rest encryption of any MySQL Encrypted data files including the binary and relay log files.

Remediation:

Enable binlogs, then create and test a restore procedure.

Default Value:

The default for `binlog-expire-logs-seconds` is `2592000` seconds, or 30 days.

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/replication-options-binary-log.html#sysvar_binlog_expire_logs_seconds
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/point-in-time-recovery-binlog.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	11.2 <u>Perform Automated Backups</u> Perform automated backups of in-scope enterprise assets. Run backups weekly, or more frequently, based on the sensitivity of the data.			
v7	10.2 <u>Perform Complete System Backups</u> Ensure that each of the organization's key systems are backed up as a complete system, through processes such as imaging, to enable the quick recovery of an entire system.			

2.1.6 Disaster Recovery (DR) Plan (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

A disaster recovery plan should be created.

MySQL Cluster (group replication), MySQL Replica Sets (asynchronous replication) or both may be used.

A replica in a different data center and offsite backups may be used. There should be information regarding the Recovery Time Objective (RTO), i.e., how long recovery will take, and if the recovery site has the same capacity. Additionally, delayed replicas can be a valuable part of a DR plan. Network (default) and at rest encryption should be used to protect data.

Rationale:

A disaster recovery strategy should be planned and formalized. Without a well-tested disaster recovery plan, it might not be possible to recover in time.

Audit:

Check if there is a disaster recovery plan.

Remediation:

Create a disaster recovery plan.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/group-replication-security.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/replication-security.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	11.1 Establish and Maintain a Data Recovery Process Establish and maintain a data recovery process. In the process, address the scope of data recovery activities, recovery prioritization, and the security of backup data. Review and update documentation annually, or when significant enterprise changes occur that could impact this Safeguard.			

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v7	10 <u>Data Recovery Capabilities</u> Data Recovery Capabilities			

2.1.7 Backup of Configuration and Related Files (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

It is important to include configurations, logs, keys, certificates, and customized files in backups.

Rationale:

Including all configuration, log, key, certificates, and customized files in any backup will ensure the backup can fully restore an instance.

Audit:

Check if these files are in use and are saved in the backup.

- Edited Configuration files (**my.cnf** and included files)
- **SET PERSIST** Configuration file (**mysqld-auto.cnf**)
- Files related to Key Management and Keyring (KMIP, other Key Management Services)
- Audit Log Files (if not handled by other methods)
- SSL files (certificates, keys)
- User Defined Functions (UDFs)
- Source code for customizations

Remediation:

Add any omitted files to the backup.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	11.2 Perform Automated Backups Perform automated backups of in-scope enterprise assets. Run backups weekly, or more frequently, based on the sensitivity of the data.			
v7	10.2 Perform Complete System Backups Ensure that each of the organization's key systems are backed up as a complete system, through processes such as imaging, to enable the quick recovery of an entire system.			

2.2 Data Encryption

This section contains recommendations for securing data at rest and in transit for MySQL.

2.2.1 Ensure Binary and Relay Logs are Encrypted (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

The `binlog_encryption` system variable may be used to configure encryption of the binary and relay logs. This may be configured to **ON** even if binary logging is not enabled in order to encrypt relay log files.

Rationale:

The database, and thus the binary and relay logs, may contain sensitive information. Encrypting the binary and relay logs protects all data stored in these logs from internal and external threats.

Audit:

To audit this setting, run the following command:

```
SELECT VARIABLE_NAME, VARIABLE_VALUE, 'BINLOG - At Rest Encryption' as Note
FROM performance_schema.global_variables where variable_name =
'binlog_encryption';
```

Ensure it is set to **ON**.

Remediation:

To remediate misconfiguration, run this command:

```
SET GLOBAL binlog_encryption=ON;
```

If you receive the error message below, you need to install keyring. For instructions see [Section 6.4.4, “The MySQL Keyring”](#) in the MySQL documentation.

```
ERROR 3794 (HY000): Unable to recover binlog encryption master key, please
check if keyring plugin is loaded.
```

Default Value:

The default for `binlog_encryption` is **OFF**.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/replication-binlog-encryption.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/mysql-enterprise-backup/9.7/en/advanced.encrypted-binlog-relaylog.html>
3. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/replication-options-binary-log.html#sysvar_binlog_encryption

Additional Information:

It is necessary to install a keyring plugin prior to configuring encryption.

Consider implementing MySQL Enterprise Backup which includes support for at rest encryption of any MySQL Encrypted data files including the binary and relay log files.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.11 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data at Rest</u> Encrypt sensitive data at rest on servers, applications, and databases containing sensitive data. Storage-layer encryption, also known as server-side encryption, meets the minimum requirement of this Safeguard. Additional encryption methods may include application-layer encryption, also known as client-side encryption, where access to the data storage device(s) does not permit access to the plain-text data.			
v7	14.8 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Information at Rest</u> Encrypt all sensitive information at rest using a tool that requires a secondary authentication mechanism not integrated into the operating system, in order to access the information.			

2.3 Dedicate the Machine Running MySQL (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

It is recommended that MySQL Server software be installed on a dedicated server. This architectural consideration affords flexibility in that the database server can be placed on a separate zone allowing access only from particular hosts and over particular protocols.

Rationale:

The attack surface is reduced on a server with only the underlying operating system, MySQL server software, and any security or operational tooling that may be additionally installed. A smaller attack surface reduces the probability of the data within MySQL being compromised.

Impact:

Care must be taken that applications or services that are required for proper operation of the operating system are not removed.

Custom applications may need to be modified to accommodate database connections over the network rather than on the host (e.g., using TCP/IP connections).

Additional hardware and operating system licenses may be required to make the architectural change.

Audit:

Verify there are no other roles enabled for the underlying operating system and that no additional applications or services unrelated to the proper operation of the MySQL server software are installed.

Remediation:

Remove excess applications or services and/or remove unnecessary roles from the underlying operating system.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>3.12 Segment Data Processing and Storage Based on Sensitivity</u> Segment data processing and storage based on the sensitivity of the data. Do not process sensitive data on enterprise assets intended for lower sensitivity data.			
v7	<u>2.10 Physically or Logically Segregate High Risk Applications</u> Physically or logically segregated systems should be used to isolate and run software that is required for business operations but incur higher risk for the organization.			

2.4 Do Not Specify Passwords in the Command Line (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

When a command is executed on the command line, for example `mysql -u admin -p password` or `mysqlsh -u admin -p password`, the password may be visible in the user's shell/command history or in the process list.

Rationale:

If the password is visible in the process list or user's shell/command history, an attacker will be able to access the MySQL database using the stolen credentials.

Impact:

Depending on the remediation chosen, additional steps may need to be undertaken like:

- Entering a password when prompted.
- Ensuring the file permissions on `.my.cnf` are restricted yet accessible by the user.
- Using `mysql_config_editor` to encrypt the authentication credentials in `.mylogin.cnf`.
- Use a pluggable secure password store, e.g., a keychain.
- In the case of shell, don't authenticate until `mysqlsh` is started, then use `\connect`

Additionally, not all scripts/applications may be able to use `.mylogin.cnf`.

Audit:

Check the process or task list if the password is visible.

Check the shell or command history if the password is visible.

Remediation:

MySQL Client:

Use `-p` without password and then enter the password when prompted, use a properly secured `.my.cnf` file, or store authentication information in encrypted format in `.mylogin.cnf`.

MySQL Shell:

Use without password and then enter the password when prompted, store authentication information in encrypted format in `.mylogin.cnf`, enter shell, then authenticate using `\connect` command (**Note:** this also ensures the username is not exposed on the command), or use `mysqlsh` pluggable password store, e.g., a keychain.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/mysql-config-editor.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/password-security-user.html>
3. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/mysql-shell/9.7/en/mysql-shell-pluggable-password-store.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.10 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data in Transit</u> Encrypt sensitive data in transit. Example implementations can include: Transport Layer Security (TLS) and Open Secure Shell (OpenSSH).			
v8	3.11 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data at Rest</u> Encrypt sensitive data at rest on servers, applications, and databases containing sensitive data. Storage-layer encryption, also known as server-side encryption, meets the minimum requirement of this Safeguard. Additional encryption methods may include application-layer encryption, also known as client-side encryption, where access to the data storage device(s) does not permit access to the plain-text data.			
v7	16.4 <u>Encrypt or Hash all Authentication Credentials</u> Encrypt or hash with a salt all authentication credentials when stored.			

2.5 Do Not Reuse Usernames (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

Database user accounts should not be reused for multiple applications or users.

Rationale:

Utilizing unique database accounts across applications will reduce the impact of a compromised MySQL account. If a user is reused, then a compromise of this user will compromise multiple parts of the system and/or application.

Audit:

Each user (excluding mysql reserved users) should be linked to one of these:

- system accounts
- a person
- an application

To list users (and exclude mysql reserved users):

```
SELECT host, user, plugin,  
       IF(plugin = 'mysql_native_password',  
        'WEAK SHA1', 'STRONG SHA2') AS HASHTYPE  
FROM mysql.user WHERE user NOT IN  
 ('mysql.infoschema', 'mysql.session', 'mysql.sys') AND  
  plugin NOT LIKE 'auth%' AND plugin <> 'mysql_no_login' AND  
  LENGTH(authentication_string) > 0  
ORDER BY plugin;
```

Remediation:

Add/Remove users so that each user is only used for one specific purpose.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	5.1 <u>Establish and Maintain an Inventory of Accounts</u> Establish and maintain an inventory of all accounts managed in the enterprise. The inventory must include both user and administrator accounts. The inventory, at a minimum, should contain the person's name, username, start/stop dates, and department. Validate that all active accounts are authorized, on a recurring schedule at a minimum quarterly, or more frequently.			
v7	4.3 <u>Ensure the Use of Dedicated Administrative Accounts</u> Ensure that all users with administrative account access use a dedicated or secondary account for elevated activities. This account should only be used for administrative activities and not internet browsing, email, or similar activities.			

2.6 Ensure Non-Default, Unique Cryptographic Material is in Use (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The cryptographic material used by MySQL, such as digital certificates and encryption keys, should be used only for MySQL and only for one instance. Default cryptographic material should not be used since it is not unique to the instance.

Rationale:

If cryptographic material is used on multiple MySQL instances and/or systems, then a compromise of one may lead to the network traffic of all servers being compromised that use the same cryptographic material. If an attacker gains access to shared cryptographic material, including default material, the attacker can reuse that material to impersonate the MySQL server or otherwise compromise its operations.

Audit:

Review all cryptographic material. If it is default, used for other MySQL instances and/or for purposes other than MySQL, then this is a finding.

Review the server certificate by running:

```
cd <data_dir and/or ssl_cert>
sudo openssl x509 -in server-cert.pem -subject -noout | grep
Auto_Generated_Server_Certificate
```

The output for the auto-generated pem will look something like:

```
subject= /CN=MySQL_Server_8.0.21_Auto_Generated_Server_Certificate
```

If no rows return, the check is a pass since the certificate is not MySQL auto-generated.

Remediation:

Generate new certificates, keys, and other cryptographic material as needed for each affected MySQL instance.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/using-encrypted-connections.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.10 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data in Transit</u> Encrypt sensitive data in transit. Example implementations can include: Transport Layer Security (TLS) and Open Secure Shell (OpenSSH).			
v7	14.4 <u>Encrypt All Sensitive Information in Transit</u> Encrypt all sensitive information in transit.			

2.7 Ensure 'password_lifetime' is Less Than or Equal to '365' (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Password expiration provides users with a unique time-bounded password lifetime.

Rationale:

This allows additional security factors pertinent to a specific user to provide further password security; predetermined by varying security needs and usability requirements in a system or organization.

Audit:

The global password lifetime is set using `default_password_lifetime`. If the value of `default_password_lifetime` is greater than `0`, it indicates the permitted password lifetime.

Execute the following command to check the global password lifetime:

```
SELECT VARIABLE_NAME, VARIABLE_VALUE
FROM performance_schema.global_variables where VARIABLE_NAME like
'default_password_lifetime';
```

A value greater than `365` implies a fail.

When the global password lifetime is less than or equal to `365`, or not configured, each user account shall be checked by executing the following command:

```
SELECT user, host, password_lifetime from mysql.user where password_lifetime
= 0 OR password_lifetime > 365;
```

A lack of results implies compliance.

Note: A value of `0` implies the password never expires.

Remediation:

To configure the global password lifetime to `365`, execute the following command:

```
set persist default_password_lifetime = 365;
```

Alternatively, configure the password lifetime for each user returned by the audit procedure by executing the following command:

```
ALTER USER '<username>'@'<localhost>' PASSWORD EXPIRE INTERVAL 365 DAY;
```

Default Value:

NULL

References:

1. <https://csrc.nist.gov/csrc/media/publications/sp/800-118/archive/2009-04-21/documents/draft-sp800-118.pdf>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/validate-password.html>

Additional Information:

When a user's `password_lifetime` is set to NULL it takes on the value set in the global `default_password_lifetime` variable.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	5 Account Management Use processes and tools to assign and manage authorization to credentials for user accounts, including administrator accounts, as well as service accounts, to enterprise assets and software.			
v7	16.10 Ensure All Accounts Have An Expiration Date Ensure that all accounts have an expiration date that is monitored and enforced.		●	●

2.8 Ensure Password Resets Require Strong Passwords (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Disabling password reuse, enforcing password strength, and denying reuse can be implemented to prevent successful usage of stolen or previously guessed passwords by malicious users.

Restricted accounts using passwords on the basis of the number of password changes and length ensure a password cannot be chosen from a specified number of the most recent passwords.

Rationale:

Repeated use of old passwords can increase risk of a compromise. This may lead to access by malicious users who have discovered a user's prior password(s).

Audit:

To assess this recommendation run the following statement:

```
SELECT VARIABLE_NAME, VARIABLE_VALUE
FROM performance_schema.global_variables where VARIABLE_NAME in
('password_history', 'password_reuse_interval');
```

A value of 0 indicates that NO policy is defined for the associated variable.

The `password_history` variable indicates the number of subsequent account password changes that must occur before the password can be reused. The `password_history` should be greater than or equal to 5, thus attempts to use any of the prior five, or more, passwords for this account will be denied.

The `password_reuse_interval` defines the global policy for controlling reuse of previous passwords based on time elapsed. For an account password used previously, this variable indicates the number of days that must pass before the password can be reused.

A password should not be reused over the period of a year. The value of `password_reuse_interval` should be greater than or equal to 365.

Remediation:

Set a global policy that passwords may not be reused for a minimum of five password changes:

```
SET PERSIST password_history = 5;
```

Set a global policy that passwords have a lifetime of approximately one year (in days)

```
SET PERSIST password_reuse_interval = 365;
```

Default Value:

Both `password_history` and `password_reuse_interval` are 0 (off) by default.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/password-management.html#password-reuse-policy>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	5.2 Use Unique Passwords Use unique passwords for all enterprise assets. Best practice implementation includes, at a minimum, an 8-character password for accounts using MFA and a 14-character password for accounts not using MFA.			

2.9 Require Current Password for Password Reset (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Require the current password for password reset.

Rationale:

Requiring a prior password for password reset enables DBAs to prevent users from changing a password without proving that they know the current password. Such changes could otherwise occur, for example, if one user walks away from a terminal session temporarily without logging out, and a malicious user uses the session to change the original user's MySQL password. This can have unfortunate consequences; the most problematic being the malicious user that can access MySQL with the user's changed credentials.

Audit:

Run the following statement:

```
SELECT VARIABLE_NAME, VARIABLE_VALUE  
FROM performance_schema.global_variables where VARIABLE_NAME in  
( 'password_require_current' );
```

The return value should be **ON**.

Remediation:

Set the value to **ON**

```
SET PERSIST password_require_current=ON;
```

Default Value:

The **password_require_current** is **OFF** by default.

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/server-system-variables.html#sysvar_password_require_current

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	5.2 <u>Use Unique Passwords</u> Use unique passwords for all enterprise assets. Best practice implementation includes, at a minimum, an 8-character password for accounts using MFA and a 14-character password for accounts not using MFA.			
v7	4.4 <u>Use Unique Passwords</u> Where multi-factor authentication is not supported (such as local administrator, root, or service accounts), accounts will use passwords that are unique to that system.			

2.10 Use Dual Passwords to Enable Higher Frequency Password Rotation (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Dual passwords act as a tool to encourage password rotations in cases where a synchronized password change is not viable. By having a time delta to have old and new passwords in place, the process of replacing old passwords with new passwords within applications is simplified.

Rationale:

Too often passwords used by applications are not changed regularly because of the difficulty in timing for propagating the new password, keeping the applications connected, and connection failures due to race conditions. If it is difficult to perform a synchronized change, you can optionally use dual passwords to simplify the task of password rotation.

Impact:

If the original password isn't removed upon completion of the password rotation process, the potential risk for a compromise is increased.

Audit:

To determine which users currently have dual passwords, run the following command:

```
SELECT user, host FROM mysql.user WHERE length(user_attributes-  
>"$.additional_password")>0;
```

If an account has a dual password and the process of password rotation has completed, this is a fail.

Remediation:

To set dual passwords execute the following **ALTER** command:

```
ALTER USER '<user>'@'<hostname>'  
  IDENTIFIED BY '<new_password>'  
  RETAIN CURRENT PASSWORD;
```

Once the new password has been distributed **DISCARD** the old password using **ALTER**:

```
ALTER USER '<user>'@'<hostname>'
DISCARD OLD PASSWORD;
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/password-management.html#dual-passwords>

Additional Information:

You may wish to first assess the state of passwords on your MySQL Server.

Password expiration is based on the policy set by the **default_password_lifetime** or by explicit settings on a per account basis.

To assess when passwords were last changed on accounts and when, or if, they will expire, run the following

```
select user, host, password_last_changed,
IF(IFNULL(password_lifetime, CAST(@@default_password_lifetime as
signed))<1, 'NEVER',
concat(
cast(
IFNULL(password_lifetime, @@default_password_lifetime) as signed)
+ cast(datediff(password_last_changed, now()) as signed), " days")) as
days_till_expires
from mysql.user;
```

Applications will fail to authenticate when **days_till_expires** reaches 0.

If **NEVER** returns for an account and the password has not been rotated in a long period of time, it is recommended that action be taken to set a new password.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	5.2 Use Unique Passwords Use unique passwords for all enterprise assets. Best practice implementation includes, at a minimum, an 8-character password for accounts using MFA and a 14-character password for accounts not using MFA.			
v8	5.5 Establish and Maintain an Inventory of Service Accounts Establish and maintain an inventory of service accounts. The inventory, at a minimum, must contain department owner, review date, and purpose. Perform service account reviews to validate that all active accounts are authorized, on a recurring schedule at a minimum quarterly, or more frequently.			

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v7	4.4 <u>Use Unique Passwords</u> Where multi-factor authentication is not supported (such as local administrator, root, or service accounts), accounts will use passwords that are unique to that system.			

2.11 Lock Out Accounts if Not Currently in Use (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Accounts that are dormant, potentially compromised, or under attack may be locked to prevent access without removing the account or its privileges. Locked accounts can be unlocked when access needs to be restored.

Rationale:

Only have active accounts that will be used.

Audit:

Review the locked status of accounts:

```
select user, host, account_locked from mysql.user;
```

Accounts not in use and MySQL Reserved accounts should show as locked (Y).

Remediation:

To lock accounts - example:

```
ALTER USER 'jeffrey'@'localhost' ACCOUNT LOCK;
```

To unlock accounts - example

```
ALTER USER 'jeffrey'@'localhost' ACCOUNT UNLOCK;
```

Note: Works for **CREATE** as well. It is good practice to **LOCK** an account if created ahead of time.

Default Value:

Accounts are unlocked by default.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/account-locking.html>

Additional Information:

When a client attempts to connect to a locked account, the attempt fails.

```
Access denied for user '<user_name>'@'<host_name>'.  
Account is locked.
```

The server increments the **Locked_connects** status variable that indicates the number of attempts to connect to a locked account. To view the **Locked_connects** execute this query:

```
show global status like 'Locked_connects';
```

The error log will contain the message **ER_ACCOUNT_HAS_BEEN_LOCKED**.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	5.3 <u>Disable Dormant Accounts</u> Delete or disable any dormant accounts after a period of 45 days of inactivity, where supported.			
v7	16.9 <u>Disable Dormant Accounts</u> Automatically disable dormant accounts after a set period of inactivity.			

2.12 Ensure AES Encryption Mode for AES_ENCRYPT/AES_DECRYPT is Configured Correctly (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

A block encryption mode with a Cipher Block Chaining (CBC) mode value and key length of 256 is recommended when using the `AES_ENCRYPT()` and `AES_DECRYPT()` functions for encryption.

Rationale:

The default for backwards compatibility on upgraded MySQL databases is `aes-128-ecb`. Using 128-bit keys does not provide sufficient security. Regardless of whether breaking the lowest level is beyond existing technology, larger key sizes are needed to better protect data and satisfy regulations.

Impact:

Configuring a key length of 256 may impact backwards compatibility.

Audit:

Run the following statement:

```
select @@block_encryption_mode;
```

A value other than `aes-256-*` is a fail.

Where `*` is one of the following - `ECB`, `CBC`, `CFB1`, `CFB8`, `CFB128`, `OFB`

Remediation:

Add the following lines to the MySQL server's `/etc/my.cnf`:

For example, if Block Encryption Mode for aes-256 CBC

```
block_encryption_mode=aes-256-cbc
```

Or, run the following command:

```
set persist block_encryption_mode='aes-256-cbc';
```

Restart the server for this change to take effect.

Default Value:

aes-128-ecb

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/mysql-secure-deployment-guide/9.7/en/secure-deployment-block-encryption-mode.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	16.11 <u>Leverage Vetted Modules or Services for Application Security Components</u> Leverage vetted modules or services for application security components, such as identity management, encryption, and auditing and logging. Using platform features in critical security functions will reduce developers' workload and minimize the likelihood of design or implementation errors. Modern operating systems provide effective mechanisms for identification, authentication, and authorization and make those mechanisms available to applications. Use only standardized, currently accepted, and extensively reviewed encryption algorithms. Operating systems also provide mechanisms to create and maintain secure audit logs.			
v7	18.5 <u>Use Only Standardized and Extensively Reviewed Encryption Algorithms</u> Use only standardized and extensively reviewed encryption algorithms.			

2.13 Ensure Socket Peer-Credential Authentication is Used Appropriately (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

The server-side `auth_socket` authentication plugin authenticates clients that connect to the MySQL server from the local host through the Unix socket file. Users authenticated by the `auth_socket` need not specify a password when connecting to the server. However, users authenticated by the `auth_socket` plugin are restricted from connecting remotely; they can only connect from the local host through the Unix socket file. This method is only suitable in situations where the server administrator OS account access is restricted.

Rationale:

This method may be desirable in specific cases, including:

- The Linux system where MySQL is running is dedicated to the MySQL server and only the MySQL DBA and OS Admin have access.
- When control over user authentication is centralized in the operating system.
- It is desirable that audit trails in the database and operating system can use the same user names.
- For certain other narrow installation use cases `auth_socket` may be desirable.
- Only local connections for a user.

Impact:

Things to consider when using the operating system to authenticate users:

- The user must have an operating system account on the computer that must be accessed.
- If a user has logged in using this method and steps away from the terminal, another user could easily log in because this user does not need any passwords or credentials. This could pose a serious security problem.
- When an operating system is used to authenticate database users, managing distributed database environments and database links requires special care. Special care must also be taken not to leave such a terminal unlocked and unattended. Hence, we recommend that you carefully evaluate your requirements before opting for `auth_socket`.
- This will not work where distributed connections are required.

Audit:

To assess this recommendation run the following:

```
SELECT PLUGIN_NAME, PLUGIN_STATUS
FROM INFORMATION_SCHEMA.PLUGINS
WHERE PLUGIN_NAME LIKE 'auth%';
```

To determine users who can use auth socket:

```
select user, host, plugin from mysql.user where plugin = 'auth_socket';
```

If this is enabled and the organization does not allow use of this feature, this is a fail.

If **host** is not the localhost or an unauthorized user is listed, this is a fail.

Remediation:

Add these options under the **[mysqld]** option group in the MySQL **/etc/my.cnf**:

```
plugin-load-add=auth_socket.so
auth_socket=FORCE_PLUS_PERMANENT
```

For example:

For an OS user which can log into MySQL using **auth_socket**:

```
CREATE USER '<user>'@'<localhost>' IDENTIFIED WITH auth_socket;
```

The user can then log in using:

```
mysql -u <user>
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/mysql-secure-deployment-guide/9.7/en/secure-deployment-configure-authentication.html#secure-deployment-auth-socket>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	6.7 Centralize Access Control Centralize access control for all enterprise assets through a directory service or SSO provider, where supported.			

2.14 Ensure MySQL is Bound to an IP Address (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

By default, the MySQL server accepts TCP/IP connections from MySQL user accounts on all server host IPv6 and IPv4 interfaces. You can make this configuration more restrictive by setting the `bind_address` configuration option to a specific IPv4 or IPv6 address so that the server only accepts TCP/IP connections on that address.

Rationale:

Limiting the IP address provides additional controls and restrictions on how client applications can connect to MySQL. If not configured to a specific IP, all IPs for this server can be used to connect to MySQL.

Audit:

Run the following statement:

```
SELECT VARIABLE_NAME, VARIABLE_VALUE
FROM performance_schema.global_variables
WHERE VARIABLE_NAME = 'bind_address';
```

No rows returned implies a fail.

Remediation:

For example, to have the MySQL server only accept connections on a specific IPv4 address, add an entry similar to this under the `[mysqld]` option group in the MySQL `/etc/my.cnf`:

```
bind_address=192.0.2.24
```

In this case, clients can connect to the server using `--host=192.0.2.24`. Connections on other server host addresses are not permitted.

Default Value:

Not set.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/mysql-secure-deployment-guide/9.7/en/secure-deployment-secure-connections.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>16.10 Apply Secure Design Principles in Application Architectures</u> Apply secure design principles in application architectures. Secure design principles include the concept of least privilege and enforcing mediation to validate every operation that the user makes, promoting the concept of "never trust user input." Examples include ensuring that explicit error checking is performed and documented for all input, including for size, data type, and acceptable ranges or formats. Secure design also means minimizing the application infrastructure attack surface, such as turning off unprotected ports and services, removing unnecessary programs and files, and renaming or removing default accounts.			

2.15 Limit Accepted Transport Layer Security (TLS) Versions (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

MySQL supports multiple protocols of TLS. The higher the version, the stronger the security and/or the better the performance.

Rationale:

Requiring clients attempting to connect to MySQL to use higher versions of TLS better protects data in transit.

Impact:

Connections attempting to use an unsupported version of TLS or Cipher will fail.

Audit:

To list the versions of TLS the server accepts, run the following statement:

```
select @@tls_version;
```

If the list includes **TLSv1** and/or **TLSv1.1**, this is a fail.

To view current connections and the version of SSL in use run:

```
select * from performance_schema.status_by_thread where VARIABLE_NAME like 'ssl_version';
```

If the list includes **TLSv1** and/or **TLSv1.1**, this is a fail.

MySQL negotiates to the highest version of TLS. If connections are using older TLS versions, those clients will need to be upgraded to newer MySQL Connectors or community drivers that support newer versions of TLS.

Remediation:

Set the version(s) of TLS you wish to accept in **mysql1.conf** to specify TLS and Ciphers.

For example to accept only TLS 1.3, set **tls_version** in **my.conf**:

```
tls_version=TLSv1.3
```

If TLS 1.3 is not supported on the Operating System then set to TLS 1.2:

tls_version=TLSv1.2

Note: with this setting, only clients that support the specified TLS version(s) are able to establish an encrypted connection to the server.

Default Value:

All TLS and cipher versions are enabled by default.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/mysql-secure-deployment-guide/9.7/en/secure-deployment-secure-connections.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/encrypted-connection-protocols-ciphers.html#encrypted-connection-protocol-configuration>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.10 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data in Transit</u> Encrypt sensitive data in transit. Example implementations can include: Transport Layer Security (TLS) and Open Secure Shell (OpenSSH).			
v8	16.11 <u>Leverage Vetted Modules or Services for Application Security Components</u> Leverage vetted modules or services for application security components, such as identity management, encryption, and auditing and logging. Using platform features in critical security functions will reduce developers' workload and minimize the likelihood of design or implementation errors. Modern operating systems provide effective mechanisms for identification, authentication, and authorization and make those mechanisms available to applications. Use only standardized, currently accepted, and extensively reviewed encryption algorithms. Operating systems also provide mechanisms to create and maintain secure audit logs.			
v7	14.4 <u>Encrypt All Sensitive Information in Transit</u> Encrypt all sensitive information in transit.			
v7	18.5 <u>Use Only Standardized and Extensively Reviewed Encryption Algorithms</u> Use only standardized and extensively reviewed encryption algorithms.			

2.16 Require Client-Side Certificates (X.509) (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Client-side certificates may be used as proof of identity as well as to encrypt data in transit.

Rationale:

Requiring client-side certificates provides additional validation of a user's identity, thus increasing the level of security, while also providing strong encryption.

Audit:

Run the following statement

```
select user, host, ssl_type from mysql.user where user not in  
( 'mysql.infoschema', 'mysql.session', 'mysql.sys' );
```

If **ssl_type** returns **X509** or **SSL**, client-side certificate details must be provided to connect.

Remediation:

Create or Alter users using the **REQUIRE X509**.

For example:

```
CREATE USER 'newuser2'@'%' IDENTIFIED BY <password> require x509;
```

For accounts created with a **REQUIRE X509** clause, clients must specify at least **--ssl-cert** and **--ssl-key**. In addition, **--ssl-ca** (or **--ssl-capath**) is recommended so that the public certificate provided by the server can be verified.

For example:

```
mysql --ssl-ca=ca.pem \  
      --ssl-cert=client-cert.pem \  
      --ssl-key=client-key.pem
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/using-encrypted-connections.html>

Additional Information:

The audit procedure excludes these internal user accounts from evaluation because, by default, they are created with an invalid password and are locked to disallow access.

- 'mysql.infoschema'@'localhost'
- 'mysql.session'@'localhost'
- 'mysql.sys'@'localhost'

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.10 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data in Transit</u> Encrypt sensitive data in transit. Example implementations can include: Transport Layer Security (TLS) and Open Secure Shell (OpenSSH).			
v7	14.4 <u>Encrypt All Sensitive Information in Transit</u> Encrypt all sensitive information in transit.			

2.17 Ensure Only Approved Ciphers are Used (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

MySQL supports multiple encryption ciphers. Ciphers can vary in strength, speed and overhead.

Rationale:

Requiring clients attempting to connect to MySQL to use strong ciphers protects data in transit.

Impact:

Connections attempting to use an unsupported cipher will fail.

Audit:

Run the following statement:

```
SELECT VARIABLE_NAME, VARIABLE_VALUE
FROM performance_schema.global_variables
WHERE VARIABLE_NAME IN ('ssl_cipher', 'tls_ciphersuites');
```

If **ssl_cipher** is not set to **ECDHE-ECDSA-AES128-GCM-SHA256** or **tls_ciphersuites** is not set to **TLS_AES_256_GCM_SHA384**, this is a fail.

Remediation:

Set **ssl_cipher** and **tls_ciphersuites** in the **mysql.conf** to an approved cipher suite:

```
tls_ciphersuites='TLS_AES_256_GCM_SHA384'
ssl_cipher='ECDHE-ECDSA-AES128-GCM-SHA256'
```

Or

Execute the following commands:

```
set persist ssl_cipher='ECDHE-ECDSA-AES128-GCM-SHA256';
set persist tls_ciphersuites='TLS_AES_256_GCM_SHA384';
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/encrypted-connection-protocols-ciphers.html#encrypted-connection-cipher-configuration>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>16.11 Leverage Vetted Modules or Services for Application Security Components</u> Leverage vetted modules or services for application security components, such as identity management, encryption, and auditing and logging. Using platform features in critical security functions will reduce developers' workload and minimize the likelihood of design or implementation errors. Modern operating systems provide effective mechanisms for identification, authentication, and authorization and make those mechanisms available to applications. Use only standardized, currently accepted, and extensively reviewed encryption algorithms. Operating systems also provide mechanisms to create and maintain secure audit logs.			
v7	<u>18.5 Use Only Standardized and Extensively Reviewed Encryption Algorithms</u> Use only standardized and extensively reviewed encryption algorithms.			

2.18 Implement Connection Delays to Limit Failed Login Attempts (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

MySQL Server can enable administrators to introduce an increasing delay in server response to clients after a certain number of consecutive failed connection attempts.

Rationale:

Delaying connection attempts provides a deterrent that slows down brute force attacks that attempt to access MySQL user accounts.

Audit:

Determine if the plugins for delaying connections are installed.

```
SELECT PLUGIN_NAME, PLUGIN_STATUS
FROM INFORMATION_SCHEMA.PLUGINS
WHERE PLUGIN_NAME LIKE 'connection%';
```

Two rows should be returned showing **ACTIVE** status.

```
CONNECTION_CONTROL | ACTIVE
CONNECTION_CONTROL_FAILED_LOGIN_ATTEMPTS | ACTIVE
```

If both plugins are not active, this is a fail.

Next, assess the setting for the connection controls by running

```
SELECT VARIABLE_NAME, VARIABLE_VALUE
FROM performance_schema.global_variables WHERE VARIABLE_NAME LIKE
'connection_control%';
```

Time doubling throttling (in minutes) between each retry (0, 1, 2, 4, 8, etc.) with a permanent account lockout (IT reset required) after 12 retries.

If **connection_control_failed_connections_threshold** is less than 5 (attempts), this is a fail.

If **connection_control_min_connection_delay** is less than 60000 (ms - 1 minute), this is a fail.

If **connection_control_max_connection_delay** is 0 or less than 1920000 (ms, 32 minutes), this is a fail.

Finally, assess the failed login attempts.

```
select host, user, JSON_EXTRACT(user_attributes,
'$.Password_locking.failed_login_attempts') as failed_login_attempts from
mysql.user;
```

If failed login attempts is less than **12**, this is a fail.

Remediation:

Add the following lines to **my.cnf**:

```
[mysqld]
plugin-load-add=connection_control.so
connection-control=FORCE_PLUS_PERMANENT
connection-control-failed-login-attempts=FORCE_PLUS_PERMANENT
connection_control_failed_connections_threshold=5
connection_control_min_connection_delay=60000
connection_control_max_connection_delay=1920000
```

Delays are in milliseconds for server response to failed connection attempt.

- **60000** (ms - 1 minute)
- **1920000** (ms, 32 minutes)

For each user set

```
ALTER USER <user> FAILED_LOGIN_ATTEMPTS 12;
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/connection-control.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	6 Access Control Management Use processes and tools to create, assign, manage, and revoke access credentials and privileges for user, administrator, and service accounts for enterprise assets and software.			
v7	16 Account Monitoring and Control Account Monitoring and Control			

2.19 Ensure FIPS 140-3 OpenSSL Cryptography Is Used (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Install, configure, and use OpenSSL on a platform that has a NIST certified FIPS 140-3 installation of OpenSSL. This provides MySQL instances the ability to generate and validate cryptographic hashes to protect unclassified information requiring confidentiality and cryptographic protection, in accordance with the data owner's requirements.

Rationale:

Federal Information Processing Standards 140-3 (FIPS 140-3) describes a security standard that can be required by Federal (US Government) agencies for cryptographic modules used to protect sensitive or valuable information. To be considered acceptable for such Federal use, a cryptographic module must be certified for FIPS 140-3. If a system intended to protect sensitive data lacks the proper FIPS 140-3 certificate, Federal agencies cannot purchase it.

Products such as OpenSSL can be used in FIPS mode, although the OpenSSL library itself is not validated for FIPS. Instead, the OpenSSL library is used with the OpenSSL FIPS Object Module to enable OpenSSL-based applications to operate in FIPS mode.

For general information about FIPS and its implementation in OpenSSL, these references may be helpful:

- [National Institute of Standards and Technology FIPS PUB 140-3](#)
- [OpenSSL FIPS 140-3 Security Policy](#)
- [FIPS OpenSSL](#)

Audit:

For MySQL to support FIPS mode, these system requirements must be satisfied:

1. MySQL must be compiled with an OpenSSL version that is certified for use with FIPS. Currently OpenSSL 3.0 is certified, but OpenSSL 1.1.1 is not. Binary distributions for recent versions of MySQL are compiled using OpenSSL 3.0 on some platforms, which means they are not certified for FIPS. This means you have the following options, depending on system and MySQL configuration:
 - Use a system that has OpenSSL 3.0 and the required FIPS object module. In this case, you can enable FIPS mode for MySQL if you use a binary distribution compiled using OpenSSL 3.0, or compile MySQL from source using OpenSSL 3.0. For general information about upgrading to OpenSSL 3.0, see [OpenSSL 3.0 Migration Guide](#)

- Use a system that has OpenSSL 1.1.1 or higher. In this case, you can install MySQL using binary packages, and you can use the TLS v1.3 protocol and ciphersuites, in addition to other already supported TLS protocols. However, you cannot enable FIPS mode for MySQL.
 - Use a system that has OpenSSL 1.0.2 and the required FIPS Object Module. In this case, you can enable FIPS mode for MySQL if you use a binary distribution compiled using OpenSSL 1.0.2, or compile MySQL from source using OpenSSL 1.0.2. In this case, you cannot use the TLS v1.3 protocol or ciphersuites, which require OpenSSL 1.1.1 or 3.0. In addition, you should be aware that OpenSSL 1.0.2 reached end of life status in 2019, and that all operating platforms embedding OpenSSL 1.1.1 reached their end of life in 2024.
2. At runtime, the OpenSSL library and OpenSSL FIPS Object Module must be available as shared (dynamically linked) objects.

If FIPS mode is required, it is recommended to use an operating platform that includes it; if it does, you can (and should) use it. If your platform does not include FIPS, you have two options:

- Migrate to a platform which has FIPS OpenSSL support.
- Build the OpenSSL library and FIPS object module from source, using the instructions from the [fips_module](#) manpage, see [FIPS Overview](#).

Your version of mysql should be a version linked to the certified operating system's OpenSSL. Run - `ldd` on your `mysqld` executable.

If `libssl` is linked to an OpenSSL library located within MySQL's installed lib directory, that OpenSSL installation is not FIPS certified. This can occur on Windows, macOS, and Linux systems where MySQL was installed using a generic tar archive.

For Linux distributions where MySQL references the operating system's OpenSSL certified library, checking for FIPS depends on the OpenSSL version.

For OpenSSL prior to 3.0

To determine whether MySQL is running on a system with FIPS mode enabled, check the value of the `ssl_fips_mode` server system variable using an SQL statement such as

```
SHOW VARIABLES LIKE '%fips%'
```

or

```
SELECT @@ssl_fips_mode
```

If the value of this variable is **1 (ON)** or **2 (STRICT)**, FIPS mode is enabled for OpenSSL; if it is **0 (OFF)**, FIPS mode is not available.

For OpenSSL 3.0 and higher

Check the operating system to see that FIPS mode is enabled. For example, on Oracle Linux 9 to verify that FIPS mode is enabled, run the following command after Oracle Linux 9 has been installed:

As the system administrator:

1. Run the following to see if FIPS is enabled:

```
fips-mode-setup --check
```

If **FIPS mode is enabled** is not displayed, then the system is not FIPS enabled and this is a fail.

2. Run the following (your results and version may vary):

```
# openssl version  
OpenSSL 3.0.7 1 Nov 2022 (Library: OpenSSL 3.0.7 1 Nov 2022)
```

OpenSSL should show a 3.0 version.

3. Check to see if OpenSSL configuration has enabled the FIPS provider.

```
openssl list -provider
```

If FIPS is not listed as a provider - OpenSSL is not in FIPS mode.

4. Test - for example

Try a non-FIPS TLS connection

```
# mysql -u root -p --host=localhost --protocol=TCP --ssl-mode=REQUIRED --tls-  
version=TLSv1.3 --tls-ciphersuites=TLS_CHACHA20_POLY1305_SHA256  
Enter password:  
ERROR 2026 (HY000): SSL connection error: error:0A0000B5:SSL routines::no  
ciphers available
```

If this succeeds, you are NOT in FIPS mode

Next connect and run

```
mysql> select md5(8);show warnings;
+-----+
| md5(8) |
+-----+
| 00000000000000000000000000000000 |
+-----+
1 row in set, 1 warning (0.00 sec)
+-----+
| Level | Code | Message |
+-----+
| Warning | 4073 | SSL fips mode error: FIPS mode ON/STRICT: MD5 digest is not supported. |
+-----+
1 row in set (0.00 sec)
```

The error was expected – demonstrates FIPS compliance.

If you are in FIPS mode - you will see the following error. If not, you are not in FIPS mode.

Remediation:

Configure OpenSSL to be FIPS compliant as MySQL uses OpenSSL for cryptographic modules. To configure OpenSSL to be FIPS 140-3 compliant, see the official documentation for your operating system.

Below is a general summary of the steps required: To switch the system to FIPS mode in Oracle Linux 9 or RHEL 9:

```
# fips-mode-setup -enable
You must reboot the system for the setting to take effect.
FIPS mode will be enabled.
Please reboot the system for the setting to take effect.
```

Before you reboot, be sure that sshd is configured for FIPS mode and that any SSH keys are FIPS mode compatible and have a password.

After the reboot, you should re-check the current state of FIPS mode:

```
# fips-mode-setup --check
```

FIPS mode is enabled.

For MySQL running OpenSSL prior to version 3.0, in the mysql configuration file add

```
[mysqld]
ssl_fips_mode=ON # or STRICT
```

For MySQL running OpenSSL 3.0 and higher

In addition to setting the operating system to FIPS mode, configure the openssl configuration for FIPS mode.

References:

1. https://docs.oracle.com/en/operating-systems/oracle-linux/9/security/configuring_fips_mode.html#enabling-and-disabling-fips-mode
2. <https://csrc.nist.gov/CSRC/media/projects/cryptographic-module-validation-program/documents/security-policies/140sp1758.pdf>
3. <https://csrc.nist.gov/publications/fips>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.10 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data in Transit</u> Encrypt sensitive data in transit. Example implementations can include: Transport Layer Security (TLS) and Open Secure Shell (OpenSSH).			
v7	14.4 <u>Encrypt All Sensitive Information in Transit</u> Encrypt all sensitive information in transit.			

3 File Permissions

File Permissions are critical for keeping the data and configuration of the MySQL server secure.

3.1 Ensure 'datadir' Has Appropriate Permissions (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The data directory is the location of the MySQL databases.

Rationale:

Limiting the accessibility of these objects will protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of the MySQL database. If someone other than the MySQL user is allowed to read files from the data directory, it may be possible to read data from the `mysql.user` table that contains passwords. Additionally, the ability to create files can lead to denial of service, or might otherwise allow someone to gain access to specific data by manually creating a file with a view definition.

Audit:

Perform the following steps to assess this recommendation:

- Execute the following SQL statement to determine the **Value** of **datadir**

```
show variables where variable_name = 'datadir';
```

Or

```
SELECT VARIABLE_NAME, VARIABLE_VALUE  
FROM performance_schema.global_variables  
WHERE VARIABLE_NAME LIKE 'datadir';
```

- Execute the following command at a terminal prompt

```
sudo ls -ld <datadir> | grep "drwxr-x---.*mysql.*mysql"
```

Lack of output implies a fail.

Remediation:

Execute the following commands at a terminal prompt:

```
chmod 750 <datadir>  
chown mysql:mysql <datadir>
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/mysql-secure-deployment-guide/9.7/en/secure-deployment-permissions.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.3 <u>Configure Data Access Control Lists</u> Configure data access control lists based on a user's need to know. Apply data access control lists, also known as access permissions, to local and remote file systems, databases, and applications.			
v7	14.6 <u>Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

3.2 Ensure 'log_bin_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

MySQL can operate using a variety of log files, each used for different purposes. These are the binary log (which can be encrypted), error log, slow query log, relay log, general log, and in the enterprise edition, the audit log (which can be encrypted). Because these are files on the host operating system, they are subject to the permissions and ownership structure provided by the host and may be accessible by users other than the MySQL user. Additionally, using secure key management and at rest MySQL encryption can further protect data from OS users.

Rationale:

Limiting the accessibility of these objects will protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of the MySQL logs.

Impact:

Changing the permissions and ownership of the relay logs and binary log files might have an impact on external tools.

If the permissions on the relay logs and binary log files are accidentally changed to exclude the user account which is used to run the MySQL service, then this might break replication.

The binary log file can be used for point-in-time recovery, so this can also affect backup, restore, and disaster recovery procedures.

Audit:

Perform the following steps to assess this recommendation:

1. Execute the following SQL statement to determine the Value of **log_bin_basename**:

```
show variables like 'log_bin_basename';
```

2. Execute the following command at a terminal prompt to list all non-compliant **log_bin_basename.*** file permissions:

```
ls -l | egrep '^-(?![r|w]{2}-[r|w]{2})----  
.*mysql\s*mysql).*<log_bin_basename>.*$'
```

Lack of output implies compliance.

Remediation:

Execute the following command for each log file location requiring corrected permissions and ownership:

```
chmod 660 <log file>
chown mysql:mysql <log file>
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/password-logging.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/mysql-secure-deployment-guide/9.7/en/secure-deployment-permissions.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.3 <u>Configure Data Access Control Lists</u> Configure data access control lists based on a user's need to know. Apply data access control lists, also known as access permissions, to local and remote file systems, databases, and applications.			
v7	14.6 <u>Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

3.3 Ensure 'log_error' Has Appropriate Permissions (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

MySQL can operate using a variety of log files, each used for different purposes. These are the binary log (which can be encrypted), error log, slow query log, relay log, general log, and in the enterprise edition, the audit log (which can be encrypted). Because these are files on the host operating system, they are subject to the permissions and ownership structure provided by the host and may be accessible by users other than the MySQL user. Additionally, using secure key management and at rest MySQL encryption can further protect data from OS users.

Much of the information about the state of MySQL exists in MySQL, the MySQL `performance_schema` or `information_schema`. In cases where the information you need is within a running MySQL, use these methods as they are more secure since they do not require OS login and access.

Rationale:

Limiting the accessibility of these objects will protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of the MySQL logs.

Impact:

Changing the permissions of the error log files might have an impact on monitoring tools which use an error log file adapter.

Audit:

Perform the following steps to assess this recommendation:

1. Execute the following SQL statement to determine the Value of `log_error`:

```
show variables like 'log_error';
```

2. Execute the following command at a terminal prompt to list all non-compliant `<log_error>.*` file permissions:

```
ls -l /usr/local/mysql/data/mysqld.local.err | grep '^-rw-----  
.*mysql.*mysql.*$'
```

Lack of output implies a fail.

Remediation:

Execute the following command for each log file location requiring corrected permissions and ownership:

```
chmod 600 <log file>
chown mysql:mysql <log file>
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/error-log.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/mysql-secure-deployment-guide/9.7/en/secure-deployment-permissions.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.3 <u>Configure Data Access Control Lists</u> Configure data access control lists based on a user's need to know. Apply data access control lists, also known as access permissions, to local and remote file systems, databases, and applications.			
v7	14.6 <u>Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

3.4 Ensure 'slow_query_log' Has Appropriate Permissions (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

MySQL can operate using a variety of log files, each used for different purposes. These are the binary log (which can be encrypted), error log, slow query log, relay log, general log, and in the enterprise edition, the audit log (which can be encrypted). Because these are files on the host operating system, they are subject to the permissions and ownership structure provided by the host and may be accessible by users other than the MySQL user. Additionally, using secure key management and at rest MySQL encryption can further protect data from OS users.

Much of the information about the state of MySQL exists in MySQL, the MySQL `performance_schema` or `information_schema`. If you can get the information you need from within MySQL, that is more secure as it does not require OS access. If you are not going to use log files, it is best to first disable (don't enable) and remove any prior logs.

Rationale:

Limiting the accessibility of these objects will protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of the MySQL logs.

Impact:

Changing the permissions of the log files may impact monitoring tools which use a log file adapter. Also, the slow query log can be used for performance analysis by application developers.

The information about the performance exists in MySQL `performance_schema` or `sys` schema views. In cases where the information you need is within a running MySQL, disable the slow query log and instead use these methods as they are more secure and do not require OS login and access.

Audit:

Perform the following steps to assess this recommendation:

1. Execute the following SQL statement to determine the Value of `slow_query_log`:

```
show variables like 'slow_query_log';
```

It is best for the slow query log to be disabled, indicated by **OFF**.

2. Execute the following SQL statement to determine the location of **slow_query_log_file**:

```
show variables like 'slow_query_log_file';
```

3. Execute the following command at a terminal prompt to list non-compliant **<slow_query_log_file>.*** file permissions:

```
ls -l | egrep '^(?![r|w]{2}-[r|w]{2}---\n.*mysql\s*mysql).*<slow_query_log_file>.*$'
```

If the slow query log is enabled, lack of output implies compliance.

If the slow query log is disabled, remove any old slow query log files.

Remediation:

Set slow query log to OFF (instead use **SYS** schema views or query **Performance_Schema**)

```
SET PERSIST slow_query_log = OFF;
```

If slow query is enabled, execute the following command to correct permissions and ownership:

```
chmod 660 <log file>\nchown mysql:mysql <log file>
```

Default Value:

Slow query log is off by default.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/slow-query-log.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.3 <u>Configure Data Access Control Lists</u> Configure data access control lists based on a user's need to know. Apply data access control lists, also known as access permissions, to local and remote file systems, databases, and applications.			
v7	14.6 <u>Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

3.5 Ensure 'relay_log_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

MySQL can operate using a variety of log files, each used for different purposes. These are the binary log (which can be encrypted), error log, slow query log, relay log (which can be encrypted), general log, and in the enterprise edition, the audit log (which can be encrypted). Because these are files on the host operating system, they are subject to the permissions and ownership structure provided by the host and may be accessible by users other than the MySQL user. Additionally, using secure key management and at rest MySQL encryption can further protect data from OS users.

Rationale:

Limiting the accessibility of these objects will protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of the MySQL logs.

Impact:

If the permissions on the relay logs and binary log files are accidentally changed to exclude the user account which is used to run the MySQL service, then this might break replication.

The binary log file can be used for point-in-time recovery, so this can also affect backup, restore, and disaster recovery procedures.

Audit:

Perform the following steps to assess this recommendation:

1. Execute the following SQL statement to determine the Value of **relay_log_basename**:

```
show variables like 'relay_log_basename';
```

2. Execute the following command at a terminal prompt to list non-compliant **<relay_log_basename>.*** file permissions:

```
ls -l | egrep '^(?![r|w]{2}-[r|w]{2}----  
.*mysql\s*mysql).*<relay_log_basename>.*$'
```

Lack of output implies compliance.

Remediation:

Execute the following command for each log file location requiring corrected permissions and ownership:

```
chmod 660 <log file>
chown mysql:mysql <log file>
```

Default Value:

<datadir> + '/' + <hostname> + '-relay-bin'

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.3 <u>Configure Data Access Control Lists</u> Configure data access control lists based on a user's need to know. Apply data access control lists, also known as access permissions, to local and remote file systems, databases, and applications.			
v7	14.6 <u>Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

3.6 Ensure 'general_log_file' Has Appropriate Permissions (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

MySQL can operate using a variety of log files, each used for different purposes. These are the binary log (which can be encrypted), error log, slow query log, relay log (which can be encrypted), general log, and in the enterprise edition, the audit log (which can be encrypted). Because these are files on the host operating system, they are subject to the permissions and ownership structure provided by the host and may be accessible by users other than the MySQL user. Additionally, using secure key management and at rest MySQL encryption can further protect data from OS users.

Much of the information about the state of MySQL exists in MySQL, the MySQL `performance_schema` or `information_schema`. If you can get the information you need from within MySQL, that is more secure as it does not require OS access. If you are not going to use log files, it is best to first disable (don't enable) and remove any prior logs.

Rationale:

Limiting the accessibility, or existence, of these log files will protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of the MySQL logs.

Impact:

Changing the permissions of the general log files may impact monitoring tools which use a log file adapter.

Audit:

Perform the following steps to assess this recommendation:

1. Execute the following SQL statement to determine the Values of `general_log` and `general_log_file`:

```
select @@general_log, @@general_log_file;
```

A `general_log` value of `0` or `OFF`, indicates the log is disabled. If `1` or `ON`, it is enabled.

2. Whether the value is `0`, `OFF`, `1` or `ON`, execute the following command at a terminal prompt to list non-compliant `<general_log_file>.*` file permissions:

```
ls -l <general_log_file>
```

If **general_log** is **0** or **OFF** (disabled) and the log file exists, remove the old general log file.

If **general_log** is **1** or **ON** (enabled), review the permissions

```
ls -l <general_log_file> | grep '^-rw-----.*mysql.*mysql'
```

Lack of output implies compliance.

Remediation:

If you can, use MySQL **SYS**, **PERFORMANCE_SCHEMA**, or MySQL Auditing as these are more secure options.

By default the **general_log** is disabled (**0** or **OFF**). It's most secure to disable the **general_log**.

To disable the **general_log_file**:

```
SET PERSIST @@GENERAL_LOG=OFF;
```

If you must use **general_log** then assure the permissions are correct. Execute the following command for each log file location requiring corrected permissions and ownership:

```
chmod 600 <general_log_file>  
chown mysql:mysql <general_log_file>
```

Default Value:

The variable **general_log** is set to **OFF** by default. The variable **general_log_file** is set to **<host_name>.log** by default.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/query-log.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.3 <u>Configure Data Access Control Lists</u> Configure data access control lists based on a user's need to know. Apply data access control lists, also known as access permissions, to local and remote file systems, databases, and applications.			

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v7	14.6 <u>Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

3.7 Ensure SSL Key Files Have Appropriate Permissions (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

When configured to use SSL/TLS, MySQL relies on Secure Sockets Layer (SSL) key files, which are stored on the host's file system. These SSL key files are subject to the host's permissions and ownership structure.

MySQL 9.7 provides ways to create the SSL certificate, SSL key, and RSA key-pair files required to support encrypted connections using SSL and secure password exchange using RSA over unencrypted connections. If those files are missing and the server was compiled with OpenSSL, it will attempt to autogenerate them at startup.

Rationale:

Limiting the accessibility of these objects will protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of the MySQL database and the communication with the client.

If the contents of the SSL key file are known to an attacker, he or she might impersonate the server. This can be used for a man-in-the-middle attack.

Depending on the SSL cipher suite, the key might also be used to decipher previously captured network traffic.

Impact:

If the permissions or ownership for the SSL key file are configured incorrectly, this can cause SSL to be disabled when MySQL is restarted or can cause MySQL not to start at all.

If other applications are using the same key pair, then changing the permissions or ownership of the SSL key files will affect those applications. If this were to occur, a new key pair must be generated for MySQL.

Audit:

Perform the following steps to assess this recommendation:

1. Locate the SSL keys and certs in use by executing the following SQL statement.
To show all ssl variables:

```
SELECT * FROM performance_schema.global_variables
WHERE
REGEXP_LIKE(VARIABLE_NAME, '^.*ssl_(ca|capath|cert|crl|crlpath|key)$')
AND VARIABLE_VALUE <> '';
```

Note: Any `mysqlx_*` values that are null default to the classic protocols equivalent value.

2. Execute the following commands at a terminal prompt to list non-compliant `<ssl_file>` file permissions:

```
ls -l <ssl_file> | egrep "^(?!r-{8}).*mysql\s*mysql).*\$"
```

Lack of output implies compliance

Remediation:

Execute the following commands at a terminal prompt to remediate these settings using the Value from the audit procedure:

```
chown mysql:mysql <ssl_file>
chmod 400 <ssl_file>
```

Default Value:

By default, MySQL enables SSL.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/encrypted-connections.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/creating-ssl-rsa-files-using-mysql.html>

Additional Information:

If SSL is not configured, this recommendation is not applicable. Using SSL is highly recommended.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.3 Configure Data Access Control Lists Configure data access control lists based on a user's need to know. Apply data access control lists, also known as access permissions, to local and remote file systems, databases, and applications.			

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v7	14.6 <u>Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

3.8 Ensure Plugin Directory Has Appropriate Permissions (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The plugin directory is the location of the MySQL plugins. Plugins are storage engines or user-defined functions (UDFs).

Rationale:

Limiting the accessibility of these objects will protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of the MySQL database. If someone can modify plugins, then these plugins might be loaded when the server starts and the code will get executed.

Impact:

Users other than the MySQL user will no longer be able to update and add/remove plugins unless they're able to switch to the MySQL user.

Audit:

To assess this recommendation, execute the following SQL statement to discover the Value of **plugin_dir**:

```
show variables where variable_name = 'plugin_dir';
```

Then, execute the following command at a terminal prompt (using the discovered **plugin_dir Value**) to determine the permissions and ownership.

```
ls -ld <plugin_dir Value> | grep "dr-xr-x---\|dr-xr-xr--" | grep "plugin"
```

Lack of output implies a fail.

Note: Permissions are intended to be either **550** or **554**.

Remediation:

To remediate these settings, execute the following commands at a terminal prompt using the **plugin_dir Value** from the audit procedure. MySQL server must not be allowed to write to this location.

```
chmod 550 <plugin_dir Value> #(or use 554)
chown mysql:mysql <plugin_dir Value>
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/install-plugin.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.3 <u>Configure Data Access Control Lists</u> Configure data access control lists based on a user's need to know. Apply data access control lists, also known as access permissions, to local and remote file systems, databases, and applications.			
v7	14.6 <u>Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

4 General

This section contains recommendations related to various parts of the database server.

4.1 Ensure the Latest Security Patches are Applied (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Periodically, updates to MySQL server are released to resolve bugs, mitigate vulnerabilities, and provide new features. It is recommended that MySQL installations be up to date with the latest security updates.

Rationale:

Maintaining currency with MySQL patches will help reduce risk associated with known vulnerabilities present in the MySQL server.

Without the latest security patches, MySQL might have known vulnerabilities which could be used by an attacker to gain access.

Impact:

To update the MySQL server, a restart is required.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to identify the MySQL server version:

```
SHOW VARIABLES WHERE Variable_name LIKE "version";
```

Now compare the version with the security announcements from Oracle and/or the OS if the OS packages are used.

Remediation:

Install the latest patches for your version or upgrade to the latest version.

References:

1. <http://www.oracle.com/technetwork/topics/security/alerts-086861.html>
2. <http://dev.mysql.com/doc/relnotes/mysql/9.7/en/>
3. https://nvd.nist.gov/vuln/search/results?form_type=Advanced&results_type=overview&search_type=all&cpe_vendor=cpe%3A%2F%3Aoracle&cpe_product=cpe%3A%2F%3Aoracle%3Amysql&cpe_version=cpe%3A%2F%3Aoracle%3Amysql%3A8.0

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	2.2 <u>Ensure Authorized Software is Currently Supported</u> Ensure that only currently supported software is designated as authorized in the software inventory for enterprise assets. If software is unsupported, yet necessary for the fulfillment of the enterprise's mission, document an exception detailing mitigating controls and residual risk acceptance. For any unsupported software without an exception documentation, designate as unauthorized. Review the software list to verify software support at least monthly, or more frequently.			
v7	2.2 <u>Ensure Software is Supported by Vendor</u> Ensure that only software applications or operating systems currently supported by the software's vendor are added to the organization's authorized software inventory. Unsupported software should be tagged as unsupported in the inventory system.			

4.2 Ensure Example or Test Databases are Not Installed on Production Servers (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The default MySQL installation does not contain any example or test databases. However, it is a good idea to review for common example databases and ensure they have been removed from production systems.

Rationale:

Dropping example databases will reduce the attack surface of the MySQL server.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to determine if the test database is present:

```
SELECT * FROM information_schema.SCHEMATA where SCHEMA_NAME not in ('mysql','information_schema','sys','performance_schema');
```

If this is a production system and a database name includes an example database, this is a finding.

Common example database names are:

- employees
- world
- world_x
- sakila
- airportdb
- menagerie

Remediation:

Execute the following SQL statement to drop an example database:

```
DROP DATABASE <database name>;
```

Default Value:

By default, MySQL 8.0 does not contain any example or test databases.

References:

1. <http://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/mysql-secure-installation.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>16.10 Apply Secure Design Principles in Application Architectures</u> Apply secure design principles in application architectures. Secure design principles include the concept of least privilege and enforcing mediation to validate every operation that the user makes, promoting the concept of "never trust user input." Examples include ensuring that explicit error checking is performed and documented for all input, including for size, data type, and acceptable ranges or formats. Secure design also means minimizing the application infrastructure attack surface, such as turning off unprotected ports and services, removing unnecessary programs and files, and renaming or removing default accounts.			

4.3 Ensure 'allow-suspicious-udfs' is Set to 'OFF' (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

This option prevents attaching arbitrary shared library functions as user-defined functions by checking for at least one corresponding method named `_init`, `_deinit`, `_reset`, `_clear`, or `_add`.

Rationale:

Preventing shared libraries that do not contain user-defined functions from loading will reduce the attack surface of the server.

Audit:

Perform the following to determine if the recommended state is in place:

- Ensure `--allow-suspicious-udfs` is not specified in the `mysqld` startup command line.
- Ensure `allow-suspicious-udfs` is set to `OFF` in the MySQL configuration:

```
my_print_defaults mysqld | grep allow-suspicious-udfs
```

No results returned is a pass.

Remediation:

Perform the following to establish the recommended state:

- Remove `--allow-suspicious-udfs` from the `mysqld` startup command line.
- Remove `allow-suspicious-udfs` from the MySQL option file.

Default Value:

`OFF`

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/extending-mysql/9.7/en/adding-loadable-function.html#loadable-function-security>
2. http://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/server-options.html#option_mysqld_allow-suspicious-udfs

Additional Information:

This option has no corresponding state in `SHOW VARIABLES`.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>16.10 Apply Secure Design Principles in Application Architectures</u> Apply secure design principles in application architectures. Secure design principles include the concept of least privilege and enforcing mediation to validate every operation that the user makes, promoting the concept of "never trust user input." Examples include ensuring that explicit error checking is performed and documented for all input, including for size, data type, and acceptable ranges or formats. Secure design also means minimizing the application infrastructure attack surface, such as turning off unprotected ports and services, removing unnecessary programs and files, and renaming or removing default accounts.			

4.4 Harden Usage for 'local_infile' on MySQL Clients (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The `local_infile` parameter dictates whether files located on the MySQL client's computer can be loaded or selected via `LOAD DATA INFILE` or `SELECT local_file`.

Rationale:

Disabling `local_infile` reduces an attacker's ability to read sensitive files off the affected server via a SQL injection vulnerability.

Impact:

Disabling `local_infile` will impact the functionality of solutions that rely on it.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement:

```
SHOW VARIABLES WHERE Variable_name = 'local_infile';
```

If `local_infile` is not in use, ensure the value returned is `0`.

Remediation:

In the case where using `local_infile` is needed, the following changes further harden security:

On the client side, secure by:

Limiting the location from where data can be read using `--load-data-local-dir`.

```
mysql --local-infile=0 --load-data-local-dir=/my/local/data
```

Adding TLS connection to assure server identity by requiring verification.

```
mysql --local-infile=0 --load-data-local-dir=/my/local/data --ssl-mode=VERIFY_IDENTITY
```

If `local_infile` is not in use or if clients are not upgraded, add the following line to the `[mysqld]` section of the MySQL configuration file and restart the MySQL service:

```
local-infile=0
```

Default Value:

`0` (OFF)

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/string-functions.html#function_load-file
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/load-data.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	4.8 <u>Uninstall or Disable Unnecessary Services on Enterprise Assets and Software</u> Uninstall or disable unnecessary services on enterprise assets and software, such as an unused file sharing service, web application module, or service function.			
v7	4.7 <u>Limit Access to Script Tools</u> Limit access to scripting tools (such as Microsoft PowerShell and Python) to only administrative or development users with the need to access those capabilities.			

4.5 Ensure 'mysqld' is Not Started With '--skip-grant-tables' (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

This option causes `mysqld` to start without using the privilege system.

Rationale:

If this option is used, all clients of the affected server will have unrestricted access to all databases.

Audit:

Perform the following to determine if the recommended state is in place:

- Open the MySQL configuration (e.g., `my.cnf`) file and search for `skip-grant-tables`
- Ensure `skip-grant-tables` is set to `FALSE`

Remediation:

Perform the following to establish the recommended state:

- Open the MySQL configuration (e.g., `my.cnf`) file and set:

```
skip-grant-tables = FALSE
```

References:

1. http://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/server-options.html#option_mysqld_skip-grant-tables

Additional Information:

This option has no `SHOW VARIABLES` counterpart.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.3 <u>Configure Data Access Control Lists</u> Configure data access control lists based on a user's need to know. Apply data access control lists, also known as access permissions, to local and remote file systems, databases, and applications.			
v7	14.6 <u>Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

4.6 Ensure Symbolic Links are Disabled (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The **symbolic-links** and **skip-symbolic-links** options for MySQL determine whether symbolic link support is available. When use of symbolic links is enabled, they have different effects depending on the host platform. When symbolic links are disabled, then symbolic links stored in files or entries in tables are not used by the database.

Rationale:

Prevents symbolic links from being used for database files. This is especially important when MySQL is executing as root as arbitrary files may be overwritten. The **symbolic-links** option might allow someone to direct actions by the MySQL server to other files and/or directories.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to assess this recommendation:

```
SHOW variables LIKE 'have_symlink';
```

Ensure the **Value** returned is **DISABLED**.

Remediation:

Perform the following actions to remediate this setting:

- Open the MySQL configuration file (**my.cnf**)
- Locate **skip-symbolic-links** in the configuration
- Set the **skip-symbolic-links** to **YES**

Note: If **skip-symbolic-links** does not exist, add it to the configuration file in the **mysqld** section.

References:

1. <http://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/symbolic-links.html>
2. http://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/server-options.html#option_mysqld_symbolic-links

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	16.10 <u>Apply Secure Design Principles in Application Architectures</u> Apply secure design principles in application architectures. Secure design principles include the concept of least privilege and enforcing mediation to validate every operation that the user makes, promoting the concept of "never trust user input." Examples include ensuring that explicit error checking is performed and documented for all input, including for size, data type, and acceptable ranges or formats. Secure design also means minimizing the application infrastructure attack surface, such as turning off unprotected ports and services, removing unnecessary programs and files, and renaming or removing default accounts.			
v7	13 <u>Data Protection</u> Data Protection			

4.7 Ensure the 'secure_file_priv' is Configured Correctly (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The `secure_file_priv` option restricts paths used by `LOAD DATA INFILE` or `SELECT local_file`. It is recommended that this option be set to a file system location that contains only resources expected to be loaded by MySQL. Even better, if data import/export using `LOAD DATA INFILE` or `SELECT local_file` is not used, the functionality should be disabled entirely by setting `--secure-file-priv` to `NULL`.

Rationale:

Setting `secure_file_priv` reduces an attacker's ability to read sensitive files off the affected server via a SQL injection vulnerability.

Impact:

Solutions that rely on loading data from various subdirectories may be negatively impacted by this change. Consider consolidating load directories under a common parent directory.

The server checks the value of `secure_file_priv` at startup and writes a warning to the error log if the value is insecure. A non-NULL value is considered insecure if it is empty, or the value is the data directory or a subdirectory of it, or a directory that is accessible by all users.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement and ensure one row is returned:

```
SHOW GLOBAL VARIABLES WHERE Variable_name = 'secure_file_priv';
```

The Value should either contain `NULL` (thus is disabled entirely) or a valid path. If set to an empty string, this is a fail.

Remediation:

If you are not going to use this feature, remove `secure_file_priv` from the `[mysqld]` section of the MySQL configuration file and restart the MySQL service.

If you need this feature, add the following line to the `[mysqld]` section of the MySQL configuration file and restart the MySQL service:

```
secure_file_priv=<path_to_load_directory>
```

Default Value:

No value set.

References:

1. http://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/server-system-variables.html#sysvar_secure_file_priv

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.3 <u>Configure Data Access Control Lists</u> Configure data access control lists based on a user's need to know. Apply data access control lists, also known as access permissions, to local and remote file systems, databases, and applications.			
v7	13 <u>Data Protection</u> Data Protection			

4.8 Ensure 'sql_mode' Contains 'STRICT_ALL_TABLES' (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

When data changing statements are made (i.e., **INSERT**, **UPDATE**), MySQL can handle invalid or missing values differently depending on whether strict SQL mode is enabled. When strict SQL mode is enabled, data may not be truncated or otherwise "adjusted" to make the data changing statement work.

Rationale:

Without strict mode, the server tries to proceed with the action when an error might have been a more secure choice. For example, by default MySQL will truncate data if it does not fit in a field, which can lead to unknown behavior, or be leveraged by an attacker to circumvent data validation.

Impact:

Applications relying on the MySQL database should be aware that **STRICT_ALL_TABLES** is in use, such that error conditions are handled appropriately.

Audit:

To audit for this recommendation, execute the following query:

```
SHOW VARIABLES LIKE 'sql_mode';
```

Variable_name	Value
sql_mode	ONLY_FULL_GROUP_BY,STRICT_TRANS_TABLES,NO_ZERO_IN_DATE, NO_ZERO_DATE,ERROR_FOR_DIVISION_BY_ZERO, NO_ENGINE_SUBSTITUTION

If **STRICT_ALL_TABLES** is not in the list returned, this is a fail.

Remediation:

Set **STRICT_ALL_TABLES** to the **sql_mode** in the server's global configuration, for example:

```
SET GLOBAL sql_mode
='STRICT_ALL_TABLES,ONLY_FULL_GROUP_BY,STRICT_TRANS_TABLES,NO_ZERO_IN_DATE,NO
_ZERO_DATE,ERROR_FOR_DIVISION_BY_ZERO,NO_ENGINE_SUBSTITUTION';
```

Default Value:

ONLY_FULL_GROUP_BY,STRICT_TRANS_TABLES,NO_ZERO_IN_DATE,NO_ZERO_DATE,ER
ROR_FOR_DIVISION_BY_ZERO,NO_ENGINE_SUBSTITUTION

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/sql-mode.html>

Additional Information:

The `sql_mode` is a set and might contain more elements than just `STRICT_ALL_TABLES`.

There is a global `sql_mode` and a per-session `sql_mode`. The per session `sql_mode` is based on the global `sql_mode` on initialization and might be changed by the application.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	16.10 <u>Apply Secure Design Principles in Application Architectures</u> Apply secure design principles in application architectures. Secure design principles include the concept of least privilege and enforcing mediation to validate every operation that the user makes, promoting the concept of "never trust user input." Examples include ensuring that explicit error checking is performed and documented for all input, including for size, data type, and acceptable ranges or formats. Secure design also means minimizing the application infrastructure attack surface, such as turning off unprotected ports and services, removing unnecessary programs and files, and renaming or removing default accounts.			

4.9 Use MySQL TDE for at rest data encryption (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Transparent Data Encryption (TDE) at rest encryption protects your critical data by enabling data-at-rest encryption in the database. It protects the privacy of your information, prevents data breaches and helps meet regulatory requirements.

Rationale:

File system based encryption does a good job of protecting against data theft on devices unable to limit physical access. It does not, however, protect against users who have or gain access to the operating system, backups, over-the-network copies, etc. Encrypting data from `mysqld` adds an additional layer of data protection.

Audit:

Check for the types of at rest encryption enabled.

```
SELECT VARIABLE_NAME, VARIABLE_VALUE, 'AT REST ENCRYPTION' as Note,  
IF(VARIABLE_VALUE = 'AES', 'Encrypted', 'Not Encrypted') as IsEncrypted  
FROM performance_schema.global_variables where  
variable_name in ('audit_log_encryption', 'binlog_encryption',  
'innodb_redo_log_encrypt', 'innodb_undo_log_encrypt',  
'table_encryption_privilege_check');
```

OFF or **NONE** indicates at rest encryption is not enabled.

To check which tables or tablespaces are not encrypted

```
SELECT  
    INNODB_TABLESPACES.NAME,  
    INNODB_TABLESPACES.ENCRYPTION  
FROM information_schema.INNODB_TABLESPACES  
WHERE NAME NOT IN ('innodb_temporary', 'sys/sys_config');
```

If any tables or tablespaces show encryption as **N** and are therefore not encrypted, this is a fail.

Backup data should be encrypted at rest as well. If you are running the MySQL Enterprise Backup verify that the backup uses **--encrypt**.

For example:

```
$ mysqlbackup --defaults-file=/home/dbadmin/my.cnf --backup-  
image=/home/admin/backups/my.mbi \  
--backup-dir=/home/admin/backup-tmp --encrypt-password backup-to-image
```

If **--encrypt-password** is not included, the backup is not encrypted; this is a fail.

Remediation:

Edit **my.cnf**:

```
# AUDIT LOG
sudo vi /etc/my.cnf
[mysqld]
audit-log=FORCE_PLUS_PERMANENT
audit-log-format=JSON
audit-log-encryption=AES
```

Execute these commands:

```
#### Table Encryption
>set persist table_encryption_privilege_check=ON;

#### BINLOG
>set persist binlog_encryption=ON;

##### REDO and UNDO
>set persist innodb_redo_log_encrypt=ON;
>set persist innodb_undo_log_encrypt=ON;

# DO NOT USE GENERAL LOG OR SLOW LOGS - USE AUDIT AND PERFORMANCE_SCHEMA.
>SET PERSIST general_log = 'OFF';
```

Run **ALTER** to enable encryption (**Note**: This will lock the table as the table is encrypted).

```
# TABLESPACES, TABLES
ALTER TABLESPACE <tablespacename> ENCRYPTION = 'Y';
// if innodb file per table (indicated by schemaname/tablename in report)
ALTER TABLE <tablename> ENCRYPTION = 'Y';
#Encrypt the system tablespace
ALTER TABLESPACE mysql ENCRYPTION = 'Y';
```

Run MySQL Enterprise Backup with encryption.

For example:

```
$ mysqlbackup --defaults-file=/home/dbadmin/my.cnf --backup-
image=/home/admin/backups/my.mbi \
--backup-dir=/home/admin/backup-tmp --encrypt-password backup-to-image
```

Default Value:

At rest encryption is off by default.

Administrators can force tables or tablespaces to be encrypted for all schemas by default by setting in **my.cnf**.

```
default-table-encryption=ON
```

or Per schema by defining **DEFAULT ENCRYPTION**:

```
CREATE {DATABASE | SCHEMA} ...
| DEFAULT ENCRYPTION [=] {'Y' | 'N'}
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/innodb-data-encryption.html>
2. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/server-system-variables.html#sysvar_table_encryption_privilege_check
3. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/create-database.html>
4. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/replication-binlog-encryption.html>
5. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/audit-log-logging-configuration.html#audit-log-file-encryption>
6. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/mysql-enterprise-backup/9.7/en/meb-encrypted-innodb.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.11 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data at Rest</u> Encrypt sensitive data at rest on servers, applications, and databases containing sensitive data. Storage-layer encryption, also known as server-side encryption, meets the minimum requirement of this Safeguard. Additional encryption methods may include application-layer encryption, also known as client-side encryption, where access to the data storage device(s) does not permit access to the plain-text data.			
v7	14.8 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Information at Rest</u> Encrypt all sensitive information at rest using a tool that requires a secondary authentication mechanism not integrated into the operating system, in order to access the information.			

5 MySQL Permissions

This section contains recommendations about user privileges.

5.1 Ensure Only Administrative Users Have Full Database Access (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The `mysql.user`, `mysql.db`, and other `mysql` tables ending in `_priv` list a variety of privileges that can be granted (or denied) to MySQL users. Some of the privileges of concern include: `Select_priv`, `Insert_priv`, `Update_priv`, `Delete_priv`, `Drop_priv`, and so on. Typically, these privileges should not be available to every MySQL user and often are reserved for administrative use only. The `information_schema.user_privileges` provides a consolidated view of all user privileges.

Rationale:

Limiting the accessibility of the `mysql` database will protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of the data housed within MySQL. A user which has direct access to `mysql.*` might view password hashes, change permissions, or alter or destroy information intentionally or unintentionally.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement(s) to assess this recommendation:

```
select * from information_schema.user_privileges
where grantee not like ('\mysql.%localhost\');
```

Ensure all users returned are administrative users with minimal privileges required.

The above query ignores MySQL internal `reserved accounts`.

Remediation:

Perform the following actions to remediate this setting:

1. Enumerate non-administrative users resulting from the audit procedure.
2. For each non-administrative user, use the `REVOKE` statement to remove privileges as appropriate.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/information-schema-user-privileges-table.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/reserved-accounts.html>

Additional Information:

Consideration should be made for which privileges are required by each user requiring interactive database access.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>5.4 Restrict Administrator Privileges to Dedicated Administrator Accounts</u> Restrict administrator privileges to dedicated administrator accounts on enterprise assets. Conduct general computing activities, such as internet browsing, email, and productivity suite use, from the user's primary, non-privileged account.			
v7	<u>4.1 Maintain Inventory of Administrative Accounts</u> Use automated tools to inventory all administrative accounts, including domain and local accounts, to ensure that only authorized individuals have elevated privileges.			
v7	<u>14.6 Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

5.2 Ensure 'FILE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The **FILE** privilege is used to allow or disallow a user from reading and writing files on the server host. Any user with the **FILE** right granted has the ability to:

- Read files from the local file system that are readable by the MySQL server (this includes world-readable files).
- Write files to the local file system where the MySQL server has write access.

Rationale:

The **FILE** right allows MySQL users to read files from disk and to write files to disk. This may be leveraged by an attacker to further compromise MySQL. It should be noted that the MySQL server should not overwrite existing files.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to audit this setting:

```
SELECT GRANTEE FROM INFORMATION_SCHEMA.USER_PRIVILEGES  
WHERE PRIVILEGE_TYPE = 'FILE';
```

Ensure only administrative users are returned in the result set.

Remediation:

Perform the following steps to remediate this setting:

1. Enumerate the non-administrative users found in the result set of the audit procedure.
2. For each user, issue the following SQL statement (replace **<user>** with the non-administrative user):

```
REVOKE FILE ON *.* FROM '<user>';
```

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#priv_file
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#privileges-provided-summary>

Additional Information:

See also: `secure_file_priv` system settings.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>5.4 Restrict Administrator Privileges to Dedicated Administrator Accounts</u> Restrict administrator privileges to dedicated administrator accounts on enterprise assets. Conduct general computing activities, such as internet browsing, email, and productivity suite use, from the user's primary, non-privileged account.			
v7	<u>14.6 Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

5.3 Ensure 'PROCESS' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The **PROCESS** privilege found in the **mysql.user** table determines whether a given user can see statement execution information for all sessions.

Rationale:

The **PROCESS** privilege allows principals to view currently executing MySQL statements beyond their own, including statements used to manage passwords. This may be leveraged by an attacker to compromise MySQL or to gain access to potentially sensitive data.

Impact:

Users denied the **PROCESS** privilege may also be denied use of **SHOW ENGINE**.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to audit this setting:

```
SELECT GRANTEE FROM INFORMATION_SCHEMA.USER_PRIVILEGES  
WHERE PRIVILEGE_TYPE = 'PROCESS';
```

Ensure only administrative users are returned in the result set.

Remediation:

Perform the following steps to remediate this setting:

1. Enumerate the non-administrative users found in the result set of the audit procedure
2. For each user, issue the following SQL statement (replace **<user>** with the non-administrative user):

```
REVOKE PROCESS ON *.* FROM '<user>';
```

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#priv_process
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#privileges-provided-summary>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>5.4 Restrict Administrator Privileges to Dedicated Administrator Accounts</u> Restrict administrator privileges to dedicated administrator accounts on enterprise assets. Conduct general computing activities, such as internet browsing, email, and productivity suite use, from the user's primary, non-privileged account.			
v7	<u>14.6 Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

5.4 Ensure 'SUPER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The **SUPER** privilege is a powerful and far-reaching privilege and should not be granted lightly.

The **SUPER** privilege shown in the **INFORMATION_SCHEMA.USER_PRIVILEGES** table governs the use of a variety of MySQL features. These features include **CHANGE MASTER TO**, **KILL**, **mysqladmin kill** option, **PURGE BINARY LOGS**, **SET GLOBAL**, **mysqladmin debug** option, logging control, and more.

Starting with MySQL 8.0, **SUPER** is deprecated and will be removed in a future version of MySQL. Migrating Accounts from SUPER to Dynamic Privileges is recommended.

Rationale:

The **SUPER** privilege allows principals to perform many actions, including view and terminate currently executing MySQL statements (including statements used to manage passwords). This privilege also provides the ability to configure MySQL, such as enable/disable logging, alter data, disable/enable features. Limiting the accounts that have the **SUPER** privilege reduces the chances that an attacker can exploit these capabilities.

It is more secure to migrate administrative users off **SUPER** and instead assign the specific and minimal set of mysql Dynamic Privileges needed to perform their tasks.

Impact:

When the **SUPER** privilege is denied to a given user, that user will be unable to take advantage of certain capabilities, such as certain **mysqladmin** options.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to audit this setting:

```
SELECT GRANTEE FROM INFORMATION_SCHEMA.USER_PRIVILEGES  
WHERE PRIVILEGE_TYPE = 'SUPER';
```

Ensure only administrative users are returned in the result set.

Remediation:

Perform the following steps to remediate this setting:

1. Enumerate the non-administrative users found in the result set of the audit procedure
2. For each user, issue the following SQL statement (replace *<user>* with the non-administrative user):

```
REVOKE SUPER ON *.* FROM '<user>';
```

Next, minimize administrator rights

1. Assess the minimal set of Dynamic Permissions needed by a user to perform their duties.
2. For each user assign the appropriate Dynamic Permission and then revoke the *<user>*'s **SUPER** capability.

For example, if administrator '*u1'@'localhost'* requires **SUPER** for binary log purging and system variable modification, these statements make the required changes to the account thus limiting rights to what is needed:

```
GRANT BINLOG_ADMIN, SYSTEM_VARIABLES_ADMIN ON *.* TO
'u1'@'localhost';
REVOKE SUPER ON *.* FROM 'u1'@'localhost';
```

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#priv_super
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#privileges-provided-summary>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	5.4 Restrict Administrator Privileges to Dedicated Administrator Accounts Restrict administrator privileges to dedicated administrator accounts on enterprise assets. Conduct general computing activities, such as internet browsing, email, and productivity suite use, from the user's primary, non-privileged account.			
v7	14.6 Protect Information through Access Control Lists Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

5.5 Ensure 'SHUTDOWN' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The **SHUTDOWN** privilege simply enables use of the shut down option to the **mysqladmin** command, which allows a user with the **SHUTDOWN** privilege the ability to shut down the MySQL server.

Rationale:

The **SHUTDOWN** privilege allows principals to shut down MySQL. This may be leveraged by an attacker to negatively impact the availability of MySQL.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to audit this setting:

```
SELECT GRANTEE FROM INFORMATION_SCHEMA.USER_PRIVILEGES  
WHERE PRIVILEGE_TYPE = 'SHUTDOWN';
```

Ensure only administrative users are returned in the result set.

Remediation:

Perform the following steps to remediate this setting:

1. Enumerate the non-administrative users found in the result set of the audit procedure.
2. For each user, issue the following SQL statement (replace **<user>** with the non-administrative user):

```
REVOKE SHUTDOWN ON *.* FROM '<user>';
```

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#priv_shutdown
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#privileges-provided-summary>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>5.4 Restrict Administrator Privileges to Dedicated Administrator Accounts</u> Restrict administrator privileges to dedicated administrator accounts on enterprise assets. Conduct general computing activities, such as internet browsing, email, and productivity suite use, from the user's primary, non-privileged account.			
v7	<u>14.6 Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

5.6 Ensure 'CREATE USER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The **CREATE USER** privilege governs the right of a given user to add or remove users, change existing users' names, or revoke existing users' privileges.

Rationale:

Reducing the number of users granted the **CREATE USER** right minimizes the number of users able to add/drop users, alter existing users' names, and manipulate existing users' privileges.

Impact:

Users that are denied the **CREATE USER** privilege will not only be unable to create a user, but they may be unable to drop a user, rename a user, or otherwise revoke a given user's privileges.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to audit this setting:

```
SELECT GRANTEE FROM INFORMATION_SCHEMA.USER_PRIVILEGES  
WHERE PRIVILEGE_TYPE = 'CREATE USER';
```

Ensure only administrative users are returned in the result set.

Remediation:

Perform the following steps to remediate this setting:

1. Enumerate the non-administrative users found in the result set of the audit procedure
2. For each user, issue the following SQL statement (replace **<user>** with the non-administrative user):

```
REVOKE CREATE USER ON *.* FROM '<user>';
```

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#priv_create-user

2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#privileges-provided-summary>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>5.4 Restrict Administrator Privileges to Dedicated Administrator Accounts</u> Restrict administrator privileges to dedicated administrator accounts on enterprise assets. Conduct general computing activities, such as internet browsing, email, and productivity suite use, from the user's primary, non-privileged account.			
v7	<u>14.6 Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

5.7 Ensure 'GRANT OPTION' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The **GRANT OPTION** privilege exists in different contexts (`mysql.user`, `mysql.db`) for the purpose of governing the ability of a privileged user to manipulate the privileges of other users.

Rationale:

The **GRANT OPTION** privilege allows a principal to grant other principals additional privileges. This may be used by an attacker to compromise MySQL.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statements to audit this setting:

```
SELECT DISTINCT GRANTEE
FROM INFORMATION_SCHEMA.USER_PRIVILEGES
WHERE IS_GRANTABLE = 'YES';
```

Ensure only administrative users are returned in the result set.

Remediation:

Perform the following steps to remediate this setting:

1. Enumerate the non-administrative users found in the result sets of the audit procedure
2. For each user, issue the following SQL statement (replace `<user>` with the non-administrative user):

```
REVOKE GRANT OPTION ON *.* FROM '<user>';
```

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#priv_grant-option
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#privileges-provided-summary>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>5.4 Restrict Administrator Privileges to Dedicated Administrator Accounts</u> Restrict administrator privileges to dedicated administrator accounts on enterprise assets. Conduct general computing activities, such as internet browsing, email, and productivity suite use, from the user's primary, non-privileged account.			
v7	<u>14.6 Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

5.8 Ensure 'REPLICATION SLAVE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The **REPLICATION SLAVE** privilege governs whether a given user (in the context of the source server) can request updates that have been made on the source server.

Rationale:

The **REPLICATION SLAVE** privilege allows a principal to fetch **binlog** files containing all data changing statements and/or changes to table data from the source. This may be used by an attacker to read/fetch sensitive data from MySQL.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to audit this setting:

```
SELECT GRANTEE
FROM INFORMATION_SCHEMA.USER_PRIVILEGES
WHERE PRIVILEGE_TYPE = 'REPLICATION SLAVE';
```

Ensure only accounts designated for replica users are granted this privilege.

Remediation:

Perform the following steps to remediate this setting:

1. Enumerate the non-replica users found in the result set of the audit procedure
2. For each user, issue the following SQL statement (replace **<user>** with the non-replica user):

```
REVOKE REPLICATION SLAVE ON *.* FROM '<user>';
```

Use the **REVOKE** statement to remove the **REPLICATION SLAVE** privilege from users who shouldn't have it.

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#priv_replication-slave
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#privileges-provided-summary>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>5.4 Restrict Administrator Privileges to Dedicated Administrator Accounts</u> Restrict administrator privileges to dedicated administrator accounts on enterprise assets. Conduct general computing activities, such as internet browsing, email, and productivity suite use, from the user's primary, non-privileged account.			
v7	<u>14.6 Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

5.9 Ensure DML/DDL Grants are Limited to Specific Databases and Users (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

DML/DDL includes the set of privileges used to modify or create data structures. This includes **INSERT**, **SELECT**, **UPDATE**, **DELETE**, **DROP**, **CREATE**, and **ALTER** privileges.

Rationale:

INSERT, **SELECT**, **UPDATE**, **DELETE**, **DROP**, **CREATE**, and **ALTER** are powerful privileges in any database. Such privileges should be limited only to those users requiring such rights. By limiting the users with these rights and ensuring that they are limited to specific databases, the attack surface of the database is reduced.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to audit this setting:

```
SELECT User,Host,Db
FROM mysql.db
WHERE Select_priv='Y'
   OR Insert_priv='Y'
   OR Update_priv='Y'
   OR Delete_priv='Y'
   OR Create_priv='Y'
   OR Drop_priv='Y'
   OR Alter_priv='Y';
```

Ensure all users returned are permitted to have these privileges on the indicated databases.

Remediation:

Perform the following steps to remediate this setting:

1. Enumerate the unauthorized users, hosts, and databases returned in the result set of the audit procedure
2. For each user, issue the following SQL statement (replace **<user>** with the unauthorized user, **<host>** with host name, and **<database>** with the database name):

```

REVOKE SELECT ON <host>.<database> FROM <user>;
REVOKE INSERT ON <host>.<database> FROM <user>;
REVOKE UPDATE ON <host>.<database> FROM <user>;
REVOKE DELETE ON <host>.<database> FROM <user>;
REVOKE CREATE ON <host>.<database> FROM <user>;
REVOKE DROP ON <host>.<database> FROM <user>;
REVOKE ALTER ON <host>.<database> FROM <user>;

```

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.3 <u>Configure Data Access Control Lists</u> Configure data access control lists based on a user's need to know. Apply data access control lists, also known as access permissions, to local and remote file systems, databases, and applications.			
v7	14.6 <u>Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

5.10 Securely Define Stored Procedures and Functions *DEFINER* and *INVOKER* (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Stored procedure and stored function declarations include a definition of permissions which can be used to escalate permissions. It's important to inspect these settings to ensure they do not unnecessarily escalate privileges.

Rationale:

A stored procedure or function that improperly escalates privileges may provide unintended access rights which can be improperly used.

Audit:

Run the following:

```
SHOW PROCEDURE STATUS;  
SHOW FUNCTION STATUS;
```

Inspect Definer and Invoker security types.

If *DEFINER* is a powerful user, consider that user's permissions.

If *INVOKER*, then the rights for the stored procedure or function are those of the user executing these.

Review code using

```
SHOW CREATE PROCEDURE <name>;  
SHOW CREATE FUNCTION <name>;
```

For more details on Procedures and Functions

```
SELECT * FROM information_schema.routines;
```

For more details on Procedures and Functions input and output parameters.

```
SELECT * FROM information_schema.parameters;
```

Remediation:

Drop and recreate stored procedures and functions using proper *DEFINER* and *INVOKER* settings, or other code changes.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/create-procedure.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>16.10 Apply Secure Design Principles in Application Architectures</u> Apply secure design principles in application architectures. Secure design principles include the concept of least privilege and enforcing mediation to validate every operation that the user makes, promoting the concept of "never trust user input." Examples include ensuring that explicit error checking is performed and documented for all input, including for size, data type, and acceptable ranges or formats. Secure design also means minimizing the application infrastructure attack surface, such as turning off unprotected ports and services, removing unnecessary programs and files, and renaming or removing default accounts.			
v7	<u>14.6 Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

5.11 Ensure Proper Use Of 'SET_ANY_DEFINER' (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

It's critical to limit users' ability to set an effective authorization ID that is used when executing a view or stored program. This grant provides a method to escalate privileges within MySQL views and procedures. A user with this privilege can specify any account as the **DEFINER** attribute for **CREATE PROCEDURE**, **CREATE FUNCTION**, **CREATE TRIGGER**, **CREATE EVENT**, **ALTER EVENT**, **CREATE VIEW**, and **ALTER VIEW**. Without this privilege, only the effective authorization ID can be specified.

Rationale:

Enabling a user to create a view, stored procedure or function that improperly escalates privileges may provide unintended access rights that can be improperly used.

Note: In previous versions of MySQL, users required a grant to **SET_USER_ID** privilege to create procedures with **DEFINER** set.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statements to audit this setting:

```
SELECT GRANTEE
FROM INFORMATION_SCHEMA.USER_PRIVILEGES
WHERE PRIVILEGE_TYPE = 'SET_ANY_DEFINER';
```

Ensure only administrative users are returned in the result set.

Remediation:

Perform the following steps to remediate this setting:

1. Enumerate the non-administrative users found in the result set of the audit procedure
2. For each user, issue the following SQL statement (replace <user> with the non-administrative user):

```
REVOKE SET_ANY_DEFINER ON *.* FROM '<user>';
```

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#priv_set-any-definer

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>16.10 Apply Secure Design Principles in Application Architectures</u> Apply secure design principles in application architectures. Secure design principles include the concept of least privilege and enforcing mediation to validate every operation that the user makes, promoting the concept of "never trust user input." Examples include ensuring that explicit error checking is performed and documented for all input, including for size, data type, and acceptable ranges or formats. Secure design also means minimizing the application infrastructure attack surface, such as turning off unprotected ports and services, removing unnecessary programs and files, and renaming or removing default accounts.			
v7	<u>14.6 Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

5.12 Ensure Proper Use Of 'ALLOW_NONEXISTENT_DEFINER' (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

It's critical to limit users' ability to set an effective authorization ID that is used with executing a view or stored program. This grant provides a method to escalate privileges within MySQL views and procedures. A user with this privilege can specify a non-existing account as the **DEFINER** attribute for **CREATE PROCEDURE**, **CREATE FUNCTION**, **CREATE TRIGGER**, **CREATE EVENT**, **ALTER EVENT**, **CREATE VIEW**, and **ALTER VIEW**.

Later, a user with escalated privileges could be created, providing unintended access rights which can be improperly used.

This permission is often needed temporarily when performing database migration. Once a migration is complete, this permission is typically no longer necessary and should be removed.

Rationale:

Enabling a user to create a view, stored procedure or function and later create a user that improperly escalates privileges may provide unintended access rights which can be improperly used.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statements to audit this setting:

```
SELECT GRANTEE
FROM INFORMATION_SCHEMA.USER_PRIVILEGES
WHERE PRIVILEGE_TYPE = 'ALLOW_NONEXISTENT_DEFINER';
```

Ensure only administrative users are returned in the result set.

Remediation:

Perform the following steps to remediate this setting:

1. Enumerate the non-administrative users found in the result set of the audit procedure
2. For each user, issue the following SQL statement (replace <user> with the non-administrative user):

```
REVOKE ALLOW_NONEXISTENT_DEFINER ON *.* FROM '<user>';
```

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#priv_allow-nonexistent-definer

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	16.10 <u>Apply Secure Design Principles in Application Architectures</u> Apply secure design principles in application architectures. Secure design principles include the concept of least privilege and enforcing mediation to validate every operation that the user makes, promoting the concept of "never trust user input." Examples include ensuring that explicit error checking is performed and documented for all input, including for size, data type, and acceptable ranges or formats. Secure design also means minimizing the application infrastructure attack surface, such as turning off unprotected ports and services, removing unnecessary programs and files, and renaming or removing default accounts.			
v7	14.6 <u>Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

6 Auditing and Logging

This section provides guidance with respect to MySQL's logging behavior.

6.1 Ensure 'log_error' is configured correctly (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The error log contains information about events such as `mysqld` starting and stopping, when a table needs to be checked or repaired, and, depending on the host operating system, stack traces when `mysqld` fails.

Rationale:

Enabling error logging can increase the ability to detect malicious attempts against MySQL and other critical messages. For example, if the error log is not enabled, then a connection error could go unnoticed.

When configured to `stderr` MySQL will send log data to the console. Logging to the console is useful, but remember it is ephemeral. This is not recommended due to the fact that logging to console does not provide a means to force restricted access via permissions strictly to MySQL and dedicated MySQL audit accounts. This may compromise the confidentiality of the MySQL log data. Furthermore, use caution if co-mingling log data from multiple sources as that can complicate log inspection. Additionally, from a security auditing perspective, it's difficult and error-prone to verify logging is correct using `stderr` or redirected `stderr`.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to audit this setting:

```
SHOW variables LIKE 'log_error';
```

Ensure the **Value** returned is a path to a file and not `./stderr.err`.

Remediation:

Perform the following actions to remediate this setting:

1. Open the MySQL configuration file (`my.cnf` or `my.ini`).
2. Set the `log-error` option to the path for the error log.

Default Value:

`./stderr.err`

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/error-log.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	8.2 <u>Collect Audit Logs</u> Collect audit logs. Ensure that logging, per the enterprise's audit log management process, has been enabled across enterprise assets.			
v7	6.2 <u>Activate audit logging</u> Ensure that local logging has been enabled on all systems and networking devices.			

6.2 Ensure Log Files are Stored on a Non-System Partition (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

MySQL log files can be set in the MySQL configuration to exist anywhere on the file system. It is common practice to ensure that the system file system is left uncluttered by application logs. System file systems include the root (/), /var, or /usr.

Rationale:

Moving the MySQL logs off the system partition will reduce the probability of denial of service via the exhaustion of available disk space to the operating system.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to assess this recommendation:

```
SELECT @@global.log_bin_basename;
```

Ensure the value returned does not indicate root (/), /var, or /usr.

Remediation:

Perform the following actions to remediate this setting:

1. Open the MySQL configuration file (my.cnf)
2. Locate the log-bin entry and set it to a file not on root (/), /var, or /usr

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/binary-log.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/replication-options-binary-log.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	8.3 Ensure Adequate Audit Log Storage Ensure that logging destinations maintain adequate storage to comply with the enterprise's audit log management process.			

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v7	6.4 <u>Ensure adequate storage for logs</u> Ensure that all systems that store logs have adequate storage space for the logs generated.			

6.3 Ensure 'log_error_verbosity' is Set to '2' (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The `log_error_verbosity` system variable, set to `2` by default, specifies the verbosity of events sent to the MySQL error log. A value of `2` enables logging of error and warning messages; a value of `3` also includes informational logging; a value of `1` logs only errors.

Rationale:

This might help to detect malicious behavior by logging communication errors and aborted connections.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to assess this recommendation:

```
SHOW GLOBAL VARIABLES LIKE 'log_error_verbosity';
```

Ensure the `Value` returned equals `2`.

Remediation:

Perform the following actions to remediate this setting:

- Open the MySQL configuration file (`my.cnf`)
- Ensure the following line is found in the `mysqld` section

```
log_error_verbosity = 2
```

Default Value:

The option is enabled (`2`) - errors and warning events are logged - by default.

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/server-system-variables.html#sysvar_log_error_verbosity

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	8.5 <u>Collect Detailed Audit Logs</u> Configure detailed audit logging for enterprise assets containing sensitive data. Include event source, date, username, timestamp, source addresses, destination addresses, and other useful elements that could assist in a forensic investigation.			
v7	6.3 <u>Enable Detailed Logging</u> Enable system logging to include detailed information such as an event source, date, user, timestamp, source addresses, destination addresses, and other useful elements.			

6.4 Ensure 'log-raw' is Set to 'OFF' (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The **log-raw** MySQL option determines whether passwords are rewritten by the server so as not to appear in log files as plain text. If **log-raw** is enabled, then passwords are written to the various log files (**general query log**, **slow query log**, and **binary log**) in plain text.

Rationale:

With raw logging of passwords enabled, someone with access to the log files might see plain-text passwords.

Audit:

Perform the following actions to assess this recommendation:

- Open the MySQL configuration file (**my.cnf**)
- Ensure the **log-raw** entry is present
- Ensure the **log-raw** entry is set to **OFF**

Remediation:

Perform the following actions to remediate this setting:

- Open the MySQL configuration file (**my.cnf**)
- Find the **log-raw** entry and set it as follows

```
log-raw = OFF
```

Default Value:

OFF

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/password-logging.html>
2. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/server-options.html#option_mysql_log-raw

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.4 <u>Enforce Data Retention</u> Retain data according to the enterprise's data management process. Data retention must include both minimum and maximum timelines.			
v7	13.2 <u>Remove Sensitive Data or Systems Not Regularly Accessed by Organization</u> Remove sensitive data or systems not regularly accessed by the organization from the network. These systems shall only be used as stand alone systems (disconnected from the network) by the business unit needing to occasionally use the system or completely virtualized and powered off until needed.			

7 Authentication

This section contains configuration recommendations that pertain to the authentication mechanisms of MySQL.

7.1 Ensure your 'authentication_policy' is Set to a Secure Option (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Define your authentication policy by setting the MySQL system variable `authentication_policy`.

MySQL 9.x supports up to three authentication factors per account definition. Use `authentication_policy` to constrain which authentication methods are permitted for each factor and to align designated accounts with the organization's MFA requirements. Where phishing-resistant authentication is required, include WebAuthn as an approved factor.

Avoid deprecated or unapproved methods such as `mysql_native_password`, and review any passwordless WebAuthn use carefully because creation of such accounts should be limited to approved use cases and authorized administrators only.

Caching SHA-2 authentication remains the default password-based method, but MySQL 9.x authentication policy should be defined explicitly rather than relying only on defaults.

Rationale:

A defined authentication policy reduces the risk of weak or inconsistent account authentication. Constraining allowed factors and plugins helps prevent use of deprecated or lower-assurance methods and supports MFA for designated accounts.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to assess this recommendation:

```
SHOW VARIABLES WHERE Variable_name = 'authentication_policy';
```

Review account authentication methods:

```
SELECT host, user, plugin FROM mysql.user;
```

Verify the configured policy supports the organization's required number of factors and approved methods. If designated accounts must use MFA or WebAuthn, verify their account definitions align with that policy.

If `mysql_native_password` or other nonapproved methods are in use where policy prohibits them, this check fails.

Remediation:

Assess the value of **authentication_policy** and set it to the organization's approved factor and plugin pattern. If users still rely on deprecated or nonapproved methods, migrate them to an approved method such as **caching_sha2_password** or another approved enterprise authentication mechanism.

Example assessment:

```
SHOW VARIABLES WHERE Variable_name = 'authentication_policy';  
SELECT host, user, plugin FROM mysql.user;
```

If WebAuthn is required for designated accounts, configure those accounts accordingly and restrict passwordless-account creation and authentication-policy changes to authorized administrators only.

Default Value:

Default **authentication_policy** allows broad flexibility. New users typically default to **caching_sha2_password**, but MFA and factor restrictions are not enforced unless explicitly configured.

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/server-system-variables.html#sysvar_authentication_policy
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/pluggable-authentication.html>
3. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/webauthn-pluggable-authentication.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	6.5 Require MFA for Administrative Access Require MFA for all administrative access accounts, where supported, on all enterprise assets, whether managed on-site or through a third-party provider.			
v7	16.4 Encrypt or Hash all Authentication Credentials Encrypt or hash with a salt all authentication credentials when stored.			

7.2 Ensure Passwords are Not Stored in the Global Configuration (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The `[client]` section of the MySQL configuration file allows setting a `user` and `password` to be used. Verify the `password` option is not used in the global configuration file (`my.cnf`).

Rationale:

Using the `password` parameter may negatively impact the confidentiality of the user's password.

Impact:

The global configuration is by default readable for all users on the system. This is needed for global defaults (prompt, port, socket, etc.). If a password is present in this file, then all users on the system may be able to access it.

Audit:

To assess this recommendation, perform the following steps:

- Open the MySQL configuration file (e.g., `my.cnf`)
- Examine the `[client]` section of the MySQL configuration file and ensure `password` is not employed.

Remediation:

Use the `mysql_config_editor` to store authentication credentials in `.mylogin.cnf` in encrypted form.

If not possible, use the user-specific options file, `.my.cnf`, and restrict file access permissions to the user identity.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/mysql-config-editor.html>

Additional Information:

There must not be a password in any of the sections of the global configuration.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.11 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data at Rest</u> Encrypt sensitive data at rest on servers, applications, and databases containing sensitive data. Storage-layer encryption, also known as server-side encryption, meets the minimum requirement of this Safeguard. Additional encryption methods may include application-layer encryption, also known as client-side encryption, where access to the data storage device(s) does not permit access to the plain-text data.			
v7	16.4 <u>Encrypt or Hash all Authentication Credentials</u> Encrypt or hash with a salt all authentication credentials when stored.			

7.3 Ensure Passwords are Set for All MySQL Accounts (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Blank passwords allow a user to log in without using a password.

Rationale:

Without a password, only knowing the username and the list of allowed hosts will allow someone to connect to the server and assume the identity of the user. This, in effect, bypasses authentication mechanisms.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL query to determine if any users have a blank password:

```
SELECT User,host
FROM mysql.user
WHERE
(plugin='sha256_password' OR plugin='caching_sha2_password') AND
LENGTH(authentication_string) = 0
UNION
SELECT User,host
FROM mysql.user
WHERE
(plugin IN('mysql_native_password', 'mysql_old_password','')
AND (LENGTH(authentication_string) = 0
OR authentication_string IS NULL));
```

No rows will be returned if all accounts have a password set.

Remediation:

For each row returned from the audit procedure, reset the password for the given user using the following statement (as an example):

```
ALTER USER <user>@<host>
IDENTIFIED BY RANDOM PASSWORD
PASSWORD EXPIRE;
```

This resets the password temporarily to a RANDOM string and returns that temporary password as a result.

The user can then use this temporary password to log in and is forced to set the password to one of their choosing upon logging in.

Note: Replace *<user>*, *<host>* with appropriate values.

Additionally, install the password policy component and define your password policy.

```
INSTALL COMPONENT 'file:///component_validate_password';
```

Edit the **my.cnf** file to define and enforce a password policy.

```
[mysqld]
validate_password.dictionary_file=/usr/share/dict/words
validate_password.length=10
validate_password.number_count=2
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/assigning-passwords.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/validate-password-transitioning.html>
3. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/validate-password.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	5.2 Use Unique Passwords Use unique passwords for all enterprise assets. Best practice implementation includes, at a minimum, an 8-character password for accounts using MFA and a 14-character password for accounts not using MFA.			
v7	4.4 Use Unique Passwords Where multi-factor authentication is not supported (such as local administrator, root, or service accounts), accounts will use passwords that are unique to that system.			

7.4 Set 'default_password_lifetime' to Require a Yearly Password Change (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Password expiry provides passwords with a time-bounded lifetime.

Rationale:

The `default_password_lifetime` global variable prevents a password from being set for an indefinite period. Excessive password expiration requirements do more harm than good, because these requirements make users select predictable passwords, composed of sequential words and numbers that are closely related to each other. More importantly, when events occur that could compromise password security, account passwords should be expired immediately.

Impact:

Scripted clients or users dependent on automated login in a controlled environment will need to consider their authentication procedures. The server will accept the user but the user is placed in restricted mode. In restricted mode, operations performed within the session result in an error until the user establishes a new account password.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statements to assess this recommendation:

```
SHOW VARIABLES LIKE 'default_password_lifetime';
```

The result should be greater than 0 and less than or equal to 365.

Remediation:

To remediate this recommendation, execute the following command:

```
SET GLOBAL default_password_lifetime=365;
```

Default Value:

0

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/password-management.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/expired-password-handling.html>

3. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/server-system-variables.html#sysvar_default_password_lifetime

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	5 Account Management Use processes and tools to assign and manage authorization to credentials for user accounts, including administrator accounts, as well as service accounts, to enterprise assets and software.			
v7	16.10 Ensure All Accounts Have An Expiration Date Ensure that all accounts have an expiration date that is monitored and enforced.		●	●

7.5 Ensure Password Complexity Policies are in Place (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

Password complexity includes password characteristics such as length, case, numeric, and character sets. For MySQL 9.x, use the `component_validate_password` implementation rather than relying on the deprecated plugin path, and combine complexity settings with dictionary checks and approved password policy values.

Rationale:

Complex passwords help mitigate dictionary, brute force, and other password attacks. This recommendation prevents users from choosing weak passwords that can easily be guessed.

Impact:

The deprecated validate password plugin can still appear in older environments, but the component-based implementation is preferred for MySQL 9.x.

Audit:

Execute the following to see if the password validation component is installed:

```
SELECT * FROM mysql.component WHERE component_urn LIKE '%validate_password';
```

If no rows are returned, this check fails.

Execute the following SQL statements to assess this recommendation:

```
SHOW VARIABLES LIKE 'validate_password%';
```

The result set should show:

- `validate_password.length` is 14 or more
- `validate_password.check_user_name` is ON
- `validate_password.policy` is STRONG
- `validate_password.dictionary_file` points to an approved dictionary file

Use the component-based implementation for MySQL 9.x; plugin-only deployment should be treated as a migration gap.

Remediation:

Install the password validation component if not already present:

```
INSTALL COMPONENT 'file://component_validate_password';
```

Persist the following configuration:

```
SET PERSIST validate_password.length=14;  
SET PERSIST validate_password.check_user_name=ON;  
SET PERSIST validate_password.dictionary_file=<path to dictionary file>;  
SET PERSIST validate_password.policy=STRONG;
```

Optionally set one or more of these if required by policy:

```
SET PERSIST validate_password.mixed_case_count=1;  
SET PERSIST validate_password.number_count=1;  
SET PERSIST validate_password.special_char_count=1;
```

Migrate from the deprecated validate password plugin to the component if legacy deployments remain.

Default Value:

By default **component_validate_password** is not installed.

```
validate_password.length=8  
validate_password.mixed_case_count=1  
validate_password.number_count=1  
validate_password.policy=MEDIUM  
validate_password.special_char_count=1
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/validate-password.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/validate-password-transitioning.html>

Additional Information:

The 'validate password plugin' can be used instead of the password validation component to enforce password complexity policies; however, it is deprecated and will be removed in a future release.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	5.2 Use Unique Passwords Use unique passwords for all enterprise assets. Best practice implementation includes, at a minimum, an 8-character password for accounts using MFA and a 14-character password for accounts not using MFA.			

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v7	4.4 Use Unique Passwords Where multi-factor authentication is not supported (such as local administrator, root, or service accounts), accounts will use passwords that are unique to that system.			

7.6 Ensure No Users Have Wildcard Hostnames (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

MySQL can make use of host wildcards when granting permissions to users on specific databases. For example, you may grant a given privilege to '*<user>*'@'%'.

Rationale:

Avoiding the use of wildcards within hostnames helps control the specific locations from which a given user may connect to and interact with the database.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to assess this recommendation:

```
SELECT user, host FROM mysql.user WHERE host = '%';
```

Ensure no rows are returned.

Remediation:

Perform the following actions to remediate this setting:

1. Enumerate all users returned after running the audit procedure.
2. Either **ALTER** the user's host to be specific or **DROP** the user.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.3 <u>Configure Data Access Control Lists</u> Configure data access control lists based on a user's need to know. Apply data access control lists, also known as access permissions, to local and remote file systems, databases, and applications.			
v7	14.6 <u>Protect Information through Access Control Lists</u> Protect all information stored on systems with file system, network share, claims, application, or database specific access control lists. These controls will enforce the principle that only authorized individuals should have access to the information based on their need to access the information as a part of their responsibilities.			

7.7 Ensure No Anonymous Accounts Exist (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Anonymous accounts are users with empty usernames ("). Anonymous accounts have no passwords, so anyone can use them to connect to the MySQL server.

Rationale:

Removing anonymous accounts will help ensure that only identified and trusted principals are capable of interacting with MySQL.

Impact:

Any applications relying on anonymous database access will be adversely affected by this change.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL query to identify anonymous accounts:

```
SELECT user,host FROM mysql.user WHERE user = '';
```

The above query will return zero rows if no anonymous accounts are present.

Remediation:

Perform the following actions to remediate this setting:

1. Enumerate the anonymous users returned from executing the audit procedure.
2. For each anonymous user, **DROP** or assign them a name.

Note: As an alternative, you may execute the **mysql_secure_installation** utility.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/mysql-secure-installation.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/default-privileges.html>
3. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/proxy-users.html#proxy-users-conflicts>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	5.1 <u>Establish and Maintain an Inventory of Accounts</u> Establish and maintain an inventory of all accounts managed in the enterprise. The inventory must include both user and administrator accounts. The inventory, at a minimum, should contain the person's name, username, start/stop dates, and department. Validate that all active accounts are authorized, on a recurring schedule at a minimum quarterly, or more frequently.			
v7	16.6 <u>Maintain an Inventory of Accounts</u> Maintain an inventory of all accounts organized by authentication system.			

7.8 Ensure 'caching_sha2_password' uses and enforces 'PBKDF2-SHA512' password storage (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

The `caching_sha2_password` authentication plugin supports multiple password storage formats. The existing storage format is CRYPT5 with SHA-256. Newer versions add support for `PBKDF2_SHA512`, which provides a stronger password transformation format.

The global dynamic variable `caching_sha2_password_storage_format` controls the preferred format used when passwords are created or changed through `CREATE USER` or `ALTER USER`.

The global dynamic variable `caching_sha2_password_enforce_storage_format` controls whether accounts using a password stored in a non-preferred format are allowed to continue authenticating normally or are forced to change their password after login.

Rationale:

Password hashes should be stored using the strongest supported format. `PBKDF2_SHA512` provides stronger password transformation characteristics than the existing CRYPT5 SHA-256 format and should be preferred for newly created or changed passwords.

Setting `caching_sha2_password_storage_format=PBKDF2_SHA512` ensures that new password transformations use the preferred format. Setting `caching_sha2_password_enforce_storage_format=ON` helps migrate existing accounts by forcing users whose passwords are stored in a different format to change their password after authentication.

The stored password transformation remains the source of truth for verification. Therefore, changing the preferred storage format does not immediately convert existing password hashes. Existing accounts must change their passwords before their stored format is updated.

Impact:

Enabling `PBKDF2_SHA512` as the preferred storage format affects password creation and password changes for accounts that use the `caching_sha2_password` plugin.

Enabling `cached_sha2_password_enforce_storage_format` may cause users with passwords stored in a non-preferred format to be required to change their password immediately after login. Such accounts will not use the fast authentication cache until their password is changed to the preferred format.

Service accounts, application accounts, replication users, and non-interactive users may be disrupted if they are forced to change passwords unexpectedly. These accounts should be identified and remediated through planned password rotation before enforcement is enabled.

In replicated environments, the same values for `cached_sha2_password_storage_format` and `cached_sha2_password_enforce_storage_format` should be configured on all primary and replica nodes. Replicas should be upgraded before the primary so that replicated account changes using the newer password storage format can be processed consistently.

Audit:

Run the following query:

```
SELECT VARIABLE_NAME, VARIABLE_VALUE
FROM performance_schema.global_variables
WHERE VARIABLE_NAME IN (
    'cached_sha2_password_storage_format',
    'cached_sha2_password_enforce_storage_format',
    'cached_sha2_password_digest_rounds'
)
ORDER BY VARIABLE_NAME;
```

The expected values are:

```
cached_sha2_password_storage_format      = PBKDF2_SHA512
cached_sha2_password_enforce_storage_format = ON
```

`cached_sha2_password_digest_rounds` should be reviewed against the organization's approved value, if a local minimum has been defined.

To identify `cached_sha2_password` accounts whose primary password is not stored in PBKDF2-SHA512 format, run:

```

SELECT User,
       Host,
       plugin,
       CASE
         WHEN authentication_string REGEXP '^\\$B\\$[0-9A-Fa-f]{3}\\$'
         THEN 'PBKDF2_SHA512'
         WHEN authentication_string REGEXP '^\\$A\\$'
         THEN 'CRYPT5_SHA256'
         WHEN authentication_string IS NULL OR authentication_string = ''
         THEN 'NO_PASSWORD_OR_UNKNOWN'
         ELSE 'UNKNOWN'
       END AS password_storage_format
FROM mysql.user
WHERE plugin = 'caching_sha2_password'
ORDER BY User, Host;

```

A finding exists if any **caching_sha2_password** account that is expected to use password authentication does not show:

```
password_storage_format = PBKDF2_SHA512
```

If dual passwords are in use, review both the primary and secondary password formats. The enforcement behavior applies to the password format actually used during authentication, not necessarily both stored passwords.

Run this query where dual password metadata is present:

```

SELECT User,
       Host,
       CASE
         WHEN authentication_string REGEXP '^\\$B\\$[0-9A-Fa-f]{3}\\$'
         THEN 'PBKDF2_SHA512'
         WHEN authentication_string REGEXP '^\\$A\\$'
         THEN 'CRYPT5_SHA256'
         WHEN authentication_string IS NULL OR authentication_string = ''
         THEN 'NO_PASSWORD_OR_UNKNOWN'
         ELSE 'UNKNOWN'
       END AS primary_password_format,
       CASE
         WHEN JSON_UNQUOTE(JSON_EXTRACT(User_attributes,
         '$.additional_password')) REGEXP '^\\$B\\$[0-9A-Fa-f]{3}\\$'
         THEN 'PBKDF2_SHA512'
         WHEN JSON_UNQUOTE(JSON_EXTRACT(User_attributes,
         '$.additional_password')) REGEXP '^\\$A\\$'
         THEN 'CRYPT5_SHA256'
         WHEN JSON_EXTRACT(User_attributes, '$.additional_password') IS NULL
         THEN 'NONE'
         ELSE 'UNKNOWN'
       END AS secondary_password_format
FROM mysql.user
WHERE plugin = 'caching_sha2_password'
ORDER BY User, Host;

```

In replicated environments, perform the variable audit on every primary and replica node. A finding exists if the values are not consistent across nodes.

Remediation:

Set the preferred password storage format to PBKDF2-SHA512:

```
SET PERSIST caching_sha2_password_storage_format = 'PBKDF2_SHA512';
```

Enable enforcement of the preferred storage format:

```
SET PERSIST caching_sha2_password_enforce_storage_format = ON;
```

Alternatively, configure the settings in the MySQL server option file:

```
[mysqld]  
caching_sha2_password_storage_format=PBKDF2_SHA512  
caching_sha2_password_enforce_storage_format=ON
```

If a site-approved value is required for digest rounds, set it explicitly:

```
SET PERSIST caching_sha2_password_digest_rounds = <approved_value>;
```

Existing accounts using the older format must change passwords before their stored password format is updated. For interactive users, expire the password:

```
ALTER USER '<user_name>'@'<host_name>' PASSWORD EXPIRE;
```

For application or service accounts, rotate the password in a planned maintenance window:

```
ALTER USER '<user_name>'@'<host_name>' IDENTIFIED BY '<new_password>';
```

After password rotation, re-run the audit query to confirm that the account's stored password format is now **PBKDF2_SHA512**.

In replicated environments, apply the same configuration on all nodes. Upgrade replicas before the primary when introducing the new storage format, and confirm that all nodes use the same values for:

```
caching_sha2_password_storage_format  
caching_sha2_password_enforce_storage_format
```

Default Value:

- **caching_sha2_password_storage_format = CRYPT5_SHA256**
- **caching_sha2_password_enforce_storage_format = OFF**
- **caching_sha2_password_digest_rounds = 5000**

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/server-system-variables.html#sysvar_authentication_policy
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/pluggable-authentication.html>
3. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/caching-sha2-pluggable-authentication.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	5.2 <u>Use Unique Passwords</u> Use unique passwords for all enterprise assets. Best practice implementation includes, at a minimum, an 8-character password for accounts using MFA and a 14-character password for accounts not using MFA.			
v7	16.4 <u>Encrypt or Hash all Authentication Credentials</u> Encrypt or hash with a salt all authentication credentials when stored.			

7.9 Ensure 'activate_all_roles_on_login' is disabled and mandatory role activation is explicitly controlled (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

MySQL roles are not effective until they are activated. When `activate_all_roles_on_login` is enabled, MySQL automatically activates all roles granted to an account at login, including explicitly granted roles and roles listed in `mandatory_roles`. This behavior takes precedence over roles configured with `SET DEFAULT ROLE`. MySQL documents `activate_all_roles_on_login` as a global, dynamic Boolean variable with a default value of OFF.

For MySQL 9.7.0 and later, `activate_mandatory_roles` provides more granular control over automatic role activation. If `activate_all_roles_on_login` is disabled and `activate_mandatory_roles` is enabled, only mandatory roles are activated in addition to the account's default roles. If `activate_all_roles_on_login` is enabled, `activate_mandatory_roles` is ignored and both mandatory and explicitly granted roles are activated. MySQL 9.5 introduced `activate_mandatory_roles`, and it is enabled by default.

Rationale:

Enabling `activate_all_roles_on_login` can increase a user's effective privileges beyond the minimum required for normal operation because every granted role becomes active at login. This may bypass the intended security boundary established by `SET DEFAULT ROLE`, where only approved default roles are activated automatically. MySQL states that `activate_all_roles_on_login` takes precedence over default roles specified with `SET DEFAULT ROLE`.

In MySQL, `activate_mandatory_roles` should be used instead of `activate_all_roles_on_login` when organization-wide baseline roles must be active automatically. This allows mandatory roles to be activated without automatically activating every role granted to each user. Mandatory roles should still be reviewed for least privilege, because MySQL treats a mandatory role as granted to all users.

Impact:

Disabling `activate_all_roles_on_login` may cause users or applications that rely on all granted roles being active at login to lose access until required roles are configured as default roles or explicitly activated with `SET ROLE`.

Enabling **activate_mandatory_roles** may cause privileges from **mandatory_roles** to become active automatically for all users. Any mandatory role must therefore be reviewed to ensure it contains only approved baseline privileges. MySQL prevents roles with the **SYSTEM_USER** privilege from being listed in **mandatory_roles**, but MySQL also recommends avoiding **SYSTEM_USER** through roles to guard against privilege escalation.

Audit:

Run the following query:

```
SELECT VARIABLE_NAME, VARIABLE_VALUE
FROM performance_schema.global_variables
WHERE VARIABLE_NAME IN (
    'activate_all_roles_on_login',
    'activate_mandatory_roles',
    'mandatory_roles'
)
ORDER BY VARIABLE_NAME;
```

The expected result is:

```
activate_all_roles_on_login = OFF
activate_mandatory_roles    = ON
```

If **mandatory_roles** is populated, review each listed role to confirm that it contains only approved baseline privileges:

```
SELECT @@GLOBAL.mandatory_roles;
```

Then review the grants for each mandatory role:

```
SHOW GRANTS FOR '<role_name>'@'<host_name>';
```

A finding exists if:

```
activate_all_roles_on_login = ON
```

Also review any instance where:

```
activate_mandatory_roles = OFF
```

and **mandatory_roles** is populated, because mandatory baseline roles will not be activated automatically unless **activate_all_roles_on_login** is enabled or users explicitly activate them.

Remediation:

Disable automatic activation of all granted roles:

```
SET PERSIST activate_all_roles_on_login = OFF;
```

Enable activation of mandatory roles when mandatory baseline roles are intentionally used:

```
SET PERSIST activate_mandatory_roles = ON;
```

If mandatory roles are not intended, clear the mandatory role list:

```
SET PERSIST mandatory_roles = '';
```

After remediation, re-run the audit query to confirm the active global values. **SET PERSIST** applies the value to the running instance and persists it across restarts. Changing **mandatory_roles** requires **ROLE_ADMIN** plus **SYSTEM_VARIABLES_ADMIN**, or the deprecated **SUPER** privilege.

Default Value:

OFF

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/roles.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	6.7 <u>Centralize Access Control</u> Centralize access control for all enterprise assets through a directory service or SSO provider, where supported.			
v7	4.1 <u>Maintain Inventory of Administrative Accounts</u> Use automated tools to inventory all administrative accounts, including domain and local accounts, to ensure that only authorized individuals have elevated privileges.			

8 Network

This section contains recommendations related to how the MySQL server uses the network.

8.1 Ensure 'require_secure_transport' is set to 'ON' (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

All network traffic must use SSL/TLS when traveling over untrusted networks.

Rationale:

Enabling Secure Sockets Layer (SSL) will allow clients to encrypt network traffic and verify the identity of the server. The SSL/TLS-protected MySQL protocol helps to prevent eavesdropping and man-in-the-middle attacks.

Impact:

Enabling SSL could impact network traffic inspection.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statements to assess this recommendation:

Check the global default.

```
select @@require_secure_transport;
```

Ensure the returned **Value** is **ON** or **1**

Remediation:

Follow the procedures as documented in the MySQL 9.7 Reference Manual to set up SSL.

Set global policy to force SSL for all connections:

```
set persist require_secure_transport=ON;
```

Default Value:

OFF

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/using-encrypted-connections.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/connection-options.html>
3. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/server-system-variables.html#sysvar_require_secure_transport

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.10 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data in Transit</u> Encrypt sensitive data in transit. Example implementations can include: Transport Layer Security (TLS) and Open Secure Shell (OpenSSH).			
v7	14.4 <u>Encrypt All Sensitive Information in Transit</u> Encrypt all sensitive information in transit.			

8.2 Ensure 'ssl_type' is set to 'X509' or 'SPECIFIED' for all remote users (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

All network traffic must use SSL/TLS when traveling over untrusted networks.

SSL/TLS should be enforced on a per-user basis for users who enter the system through the network.

Rationale:

The SSL/TLS-protected MySQL protocol helps to prevent eavesdropping and man-in-the-middle attacks.

Impact:

When SSL/TLS is enforced, then clients which do not use SSL will not be able to connect. If the server is not configured for SSL/TLS, then accounts for which SSL/TLS is mandatory will not be able to connect.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statements to assess this recommendation:

```
SELECT user, host, ssl_type FROM mysql.user  
WHERE NOT HOST IN ('::1', '127.0.0.1', 'localhost');
```

Ensure the **ssl_type** for each user returned is equal to **X509** or **SPECIFIED**.

Note: **ANY** means the connection must be using TLS and could optionally provide a client-side certificate.

Remediation:

Use the ALTER USER statement to require the use of SSL:

```
ALTER USER 'my_user'@'app1.example.com' REQUIRE X509;
```

Note: **REQUIRE SSL** only enforces SSL. There are additional options **REQUIRE ISSUER**, **REQUIRE SUBJECT** which can be used to further restrict the connection.

Default Value:

On the server-side, SSL is **ON** by default **--ssl** (permits but does not require secure connections) and **require_secure_transport** is **OFF** (turning **ON** allows only secure connections)

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/using-encrypted-connections.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/alter-user.html#alter-user-tls>
3. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/connection-options.html#option_general_ssl

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.10 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data in Transit</u> Encrypt sensitive data in transit. Example implementations can include: Transport Layer Security (TLS) and Open Secure Shell (OpenSSH).			
v7	14.4 <u>Encrypt All Sensitive Information in Transit</u> Encrypt all sensitive information in transit.			

8.3 Set Maximum Connection Limits for Server and per User (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Limiting concurrent connections to a MySQL server can be used to reduce risk of Denial of Service (DoS) attacks performed by exhausting connection resources.

Rationale:

Limiting the number of concurrent sessions at the server and per user level helps to reduce the risk of DoS attacks. MySQL provides mechanisms to limit the number of simultaneous connections that can be made at the server level or by any given account.

Audit:

To check global (default) concurrent-sessions settings in the MySQL database server and the per-user default, run the following query:

```
SELECT VARIABLE_NAME, VARIABLE_VALUE
FROM performance_schema.global_variables
WHERE VARIABLE_NAME LIKE 'max_%connections';
```

If the value of `max_user_connections` is `0` this means there is no limit.

If the value of `max_connections` is not set, there is no limit.

Also check the values on a per-user basis by running the following:

```
select user, host, max_user_connections from mysql.user where user not like
'mysql.%' and user not like 'root';
```

If the value is `0`, this means the global value of `max_user_connections` applies.

If no limits are configured, this is a fail.

Remediation:

Connect to the MySQL Database as an administrator.

For example, to set the global default per user to `50` run the command:

```
SET PERSIST max_user_connections=50;
```

To control the maximum number of clients the server permits to connect simultaneously, set the `max_connections` system variable:

```
SET PERSIST max_connections=1000;
```

Additionally, **MAX_USER_CONNECTIONS** can be set per user as well as for a given period of time using **CREATE** or **ALTER**.

For example:

```
ALTER USER 'fred'@'localhost'  
WITH MAX_CONNECTIONS_PER_HOUR 5  
MAX_USER_CONNECTIONS 2;
```

Default Value:

The default value of **max_connections** is 151, **max_user_connections** is 0 (unlimited, thus limited by **max_connections**).

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/user-resources.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/connection-interfaces.html#connection-interfaces-volume-management>

9 Replication

Everything related to replicating data from one server to another.

9.1 Ensure Replication Traffic is Secured (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS

Description:

The replication traffic between servers should be secured. Security measures should include ensuring the confidentiality and integrity of the traffic, and performing mutual authentication between the servers before performing replication.

Rationale:

The replication traffic should be secured as it gives access to all transferred information and might leak passwords. When the replication traffic is not secured, someone might be able to capture passwords and other sensitive information when sent to the replica.

Audit:

Check if the replication traffic is using one or more of the following to provide confidentiality and integrity for the traffic, and mutual authentication for the servers:

- private network
- VPN
- SSL/TLS
- SSH Tunnel

Remediation:

Secure the network traffic using one or more technologies to provide confidentiality and integrity for the traffic, and mutual authentication for the servers.

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.10 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data in Transit</u> Encrypt sensitive data in transit. Example implementations can include: Transport Layer Security (TLS) and Open Secure Shell (OpenSSH).			
v7	14.4 <u>Encrypt All Sensitive Information in Transit</u> Encrypt all sensitive information in transit.			

9.2 Ensure 'SOURCE_SSL_VERIFY_SERVER_CERT' is Set to 'YES' or '1' (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

In the MySQL **REPLICA** (**SLAVE** is deprecated as of 8.0.22) context the setting **SOURCE_SSL_VERIFY_SERVER_CERT** (**MASTER_SSL_VERIFY_SERVER_CERT** is deprecated as of 8.0.22) indicates whether the **REPLICA** should verify the **SOURCE**'s certificate. This configuration item may be set to **Yes** or **No**, and unless SSL has been enabled on the **REPLICA**, the value will be ignored.

Rationale:

When SSL is in use, certificate verification is important to authenticate the party to which a connection is being made. In this case, the **REPLICA** (client) should verify the **SOURCE**'s (server's) certificate to authenticate the **SOURCE** prior to continuing the connection.

Impact:

When using **CHANGE REPLICATION SOURCE TO** (**CHANGE MASTER** is deprecated as of 8.0.23), be aware of the following:

- **REPLICA** processes need to be stopped prior to executing **CHANGE SOURCE TO**
- Use of **CHANGE REPLICATION SOURCE TO** starts new relay logs without keeping the old ones unless explicitly told to keep them
- When **CHANGE REPLICATION SOURCE TO** is invoked, some information is dumped to the error log (previous values for **SOURCE_HOST**, **SOURCE_PORT**, **SOURCE_LOG_FILE**, and **SOURCE_LOG_POS**)
- Invoking **CHANGE REPLICATION SOURCE TO** will implicitly commit any ongoing transactions in the session where the **CHANGE REPLICATION SOURCE** was run, but not all ongoing transactions on the database.

Audit:

To assess this recommendation, issue the following statement:

```
select ssl_verify_server_cert from mysql.slave_master_info;
```

Verify the value of **ssl_verify_server_cert** is **1**.

Remediation:

To remediate this setting, you must use the **CHANGE SOURCE TO** command.

```
STOP REPLICA; -- required if replication was already running
CHANGE REPLICATION SOURCE TO SOURCE_SSL_VERIFY_SERVER_CERT=1;
START REPLICA; -- required if you want to restart replication
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/change-replication-source-to.html>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/change-master-to.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.10 Encrypt Sensitive Data in Transit Encrypt sensitive data in transit. Example implementations can include: Transport Layer Security (TLS) and Open Secure Shell (OpenSSH).			

9.3 Ensure 'super_priv' is Not Set to 'Y' for Replication Users (Automated)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

The **SUPER** privilege found in the `mysql.user` table governs the use of a variety of MySQL features. These features include **CHANGE MASTER TO**, **KILL**, `mysqladmin kill` option, **PURGE BINARY LOGS**, **SET GLOBAL**, `mysqladmin debug` option, logging control, and more.

Rationale:

The **SUPER** privilege allows principals to perform many actions, including view and terminate currently executing MySQL statements (including statements used to manage passwords). This privilege also provides the ability to configure MySQL, such as enabling/disabling logging or features, as well as the ability to alter data. Limiting the accounts that have the **SUPER** privilege reduces the chances that an attacker can exploit these capabilities.

Impact:

When the **SUPER** privilege is denied to a given user, that user will be unable to take advantage of certain capabilities, such as certain `mysqladmin` options.

Audit:

Execute the following SQL statement to audit this setting:

```
select user, host from mysql.user where user='repl' and Super_priv = 'Y';
```

No rows should be returned.

If you wish to validate permissions in more detail:

```
select * from mysql.user where user='repl'\G
```

The following columns should return **Y**.

```

***** 1. row *****
      Select_priv: Y
      Reload_priv: Y
      Shutdown_priv: Y
      Process_priv: Y
      File_priv: Y
      Grant_priv: Y
      Execute_priv: Y
      Repl_slave_priv: Y
      Repl_client_priv: Y
      Create_user_priv: Y

1 row in set (0.0007 sec)

```

Check Dynamic Privileges:

```
select PRIV from mysql.global_grants where user like 'repl'\G
```

Expected results are:

```

BACKUP_ADMIN
CLONE_ADMIN
PERSIST_RO_VARIABLES_ADMIN
REPLICATION_SLAVE_ADMIN
SYSTEM_VARIABLES_ADMIN

```

Note: Substitute your replication user's name for **repl** in the above queries.

Remediation:

Execute the following steps to remediate this setting:

1. Enumerate the replication users found in the result set of the audit procedure
2. For each replication user, issue the following SQL statement (replace **repl** with your replication user's name):

```
REVOKE SUPER ON *.* FROM 'repl';
```

References:

1. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/privileges-provided.html#priv_super
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/deploying-innodb-replicasets.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	<u>5.4 Restrict Administrator Privileges to Dedicated Administrator Accounts</u> Restrict administrator privileges to dedicated administrator accounts on enterprise assets. Conduct general computing activities, such as internet browsing, email, and productivity suite use, from the user's primary, non-privileged account.			
v7	<u>14 Controlled Access Based on the Need to Know</u> Controlled Access Based on the Need to Know			

10 MySQL InnoDB Cluster / Group Replication

MySQL InnoDB cluster provides a complete high availability solution for MySQL. MySQL Shell includes AdminAPI which enables you to easily configure and administer a group of at least three MySQL server instances to function as an InnoDB cluster. Each MySQL server instance runs MySQL Group Replication, which provides the mechanism to replicate data within InnoDB clusters, with built-in failover. AdminAPI removes the need to work directly with Group Replication in InnoDB clusters.

Various things can be configured to enhance the security of MySQL InnoDB Cluster.

10.1 Ensure All Group Replication Traffic is Secured (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 1 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

MySQL group communication connections and distributed recovery connections can be secured using SSL.

Rationale:

SSL encryption ensures data cannot be seen over the network for Group Replication.

Audit:

Using MySQL InnoDB Cluster Admin API: Run using MySQL shell:

```
mysql-js> var cluster = dba.getCluster()
mysql-js> cluster.status()
{
  "clusterName": "testCluster",
  "defaultReplicaSet": {
    "name": "default",
    "primary": "localhost:3320",
    "ssl": "REQUIRED",
    "status": "OK",
```

ssl should **not** be **DISABLED**.

Run the following statement from mysql client:

```
select @@group_replication_ssl_mode;
```

If **DISABLED**, communication is not secure which, is a finding.

REQUIRED, **VERIFY_CA**, or **VERIFY_IDENTITY** - indicates SSL is required.

Remediation:

Edit **my.cnf** and set **group_replication_ssl_mode**, for example:

```
group_replication_ssl_mode=REQUIRED
```

Acceptable values are:

- **REQUIRED** - Establish a secure connection if the server supports secure connections.
- **VERIFY_CA** - Like **REQUIRED**, but additionally verify the server TLS certificate against the configured Certificate Authority (CA) certificates.

- **VERIFY_IDENTITY** - Like **VERIFY_CA**, but additionally verify that the server certificate matches the host to which the connection is being established.

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/group-replication-secure-socket-layer-support-ssl.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.10 <u>Encrypt Sensitive Data in Transit</u> Encrypt sensitive data in transit. Example implementations can include: Transport Layer Security (TLS) and Open Secure Shell (OpenSSH).			
v7	14.4 <u>Encrypt All Sensitive Information in Transit</u> Encrypt all sensitive information in transit.			

10.2 Allowlist Approved Servers Belonging to a MySQL InnoDB Cluster (Manual)

Profile Applicability:

- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS
- Level 2 - MySQL RDBMS on Linux

Description:

Optionally, specify an allowlist of approved servers that belong to the MySQL InnoDB Cluster.

Rationale:

When using MySQL InnoDB Cluster by specifying the allowlist explicitly, you can increase the security of your cluster as only servers in the allowlist are allowed to connect to the cluster.

Audit:

Open MySQL Shell and execute the following command to get the allowlist of servers. This list is comma-separated, surrounded by quotes. For example:

```
select @@group_replication_ip_allowlist
```

The result set from the above statement should be the IPs (IPv4/IPv6) or hostnames allowed to join the MySQL InnoDB Cluster (Group).

Remediation:

For example, to configure a cluster to only accept connections from servers at addresses **203.0.113.0/24** and **198.51.100.110**. The allowlist can also include host names, which are resolved only when a connection request is made by another server.

```
mysql-js> cluster.addInstance("icadmin@ic-3:3306", {ipAllowlist:  
"203.0.113.0/24, 198.51.100.110"})
```

References:

1. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/mysql-innodb-cluster-working-with-cluster.html#mysql-innodb-cluster-securing>
2. <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/group-replication-ip-address-permissions.html>

CIS Controls:

Controls Version	Control	IG 1	IG 2	IG 3
v8	3.3 <u>Configure Data Access Control Lists</u> Configure data access control lists based on a user's need to know. Apply data access control lists, also known as access permissions, to local and remote file systems, databases, and applications.			

Appendix: Summary Table

CIS Benchmark Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
1	Operating System Level Configuration		
1.1	Place Databases on Non-System Partitions (Manual)	☐	☐
1.2	Use Dedicated Least Privileged Account for MySQL Daemon/Service (Automated)	☐	☐
1.3	Disable MySQL Command History (Automated)	☐	☐
1.4	Verify That the MYSQL_PWD Environment Variable is Not in Use (Automated)	☐	☐
1.5	Ensure Interactive Login is Disabled (Automated)	☐	☐
1.6	Verify That 'MYSQL_PWD' is Not Set in Users' Profiles (Automated)	☐	☐
1.7	Ensure MySQL is Run Under a Sandbox Environment (Manual)	☐	☐
2	Installation and Planning		
2.1	Backup and Disaster Recovery		
2.1.1	Backup Policy in Place (Manual)	☐	☐
2.1.2	Verify Backups are Good (Manual)	☐	☐
2.1.3	Secure Backup Credentials (Manual)	☐	☐
2.1.4	The Backups Should be Properly Secured (Manual)	☐	☐
2.1.5	Point-in-Time Recovery (Automated)	☐	☐
2.1.6	Disaster Recovery (DR) Plan (Manual)	☐	☐
2.1.7	Backup of Configuration and Related Files (Manual)	☐	☐
2.2	Data Encryption		

CIS Benchmark Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
2.2.1	Ensure Binary and Relay Logs are Encrypted (Automated)	☐	☐
2.3	Dedicate the Machine Running MySQL (Manual)	☐	☐
2.4	Do Not Specify Passwords in the Command Line (Manual)	☐	☐
2.5	Do Not Reuse Usernames (Manual)	☐	☐
2.6	Ensure Non-Default, Unique Cryptographic Material is in Use (Manual)	☐	☐
2.7	Ensure 'password_lifetime' is Less Than or Equal to '365' (Automated)	☐	☐
2.8	Ensure Password Resets Require Strong Passwords (Automated)	☐	☐
2.9	Require Current Password for Password Reset (Automated)	☐	☐
2.10	Use Dual Passwords to Enable Higher Frequency Password Rotation (Manual)	☐	☐
2.11	Lock Out Accounts if Not Currently in Use (Manual)	☐	☐
2.12	Ensure AES Encryption Mode for AES_ENCRYPT/AES_DECRYPT is Configured Correctly (Automated)	☐	☐
2.13	Ensure Socket Peer-Credential Authentication is Used Appropriately (Manual)	☐	☐
2.14	Ensure MySQL is Bound to an IP Address (Automated)	☐	☐
2.15	Limit Accepted Transport Layer Security (TLS) Versions (Automated)	☐	☐
2.16	Require Client-Side Certificates (X.509) (Automated)	☐	☐
2.17	Ensure Only Approved Ciphers are Used (Automated)	☐	☐

CIS Benchmark Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
2.18	Implement Connection Delays to Limit Failed Login Attempts (Automated)	☐	☐
2.19	Ensure FIPS 140-3 OpenSSL Cryptography Is Used (Manual)	☐	☐
3	File Permissions		
3.1	Ensure 'datadir' Has Appropriate Permissions (Automated)	☐	☐
3.2	Ensure 'log_bin_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions (Automated)	☐	☐
3.3	Ensure 'log_error' Has Appropriate Permissions (Automated)	☐	☐
3.4	Ensure 'slow_query_log' Has Appropriate Permissions (Automated)	☐	☐
3.5	Ensure 'relay_log_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions (Automated)	☐	☐
3.6	Ensure 'general_log_file' Has Appropriate Permissions (Automated)	☐	☐
3.7	Ensure SSL Key Files Have Appropriate Permissions (Automated)	☐	☐
3.8	Ensure Plugin Directory Has Appropriate Permissions (Automated)	☐	☐
4	General		
4.1	Ensure the Latest Security Patches are Applied (Manual)	☐	☐
4.2	Ensure Example or Test Databases are Not Installed on Production Servers (Automated)	☐	☐
4.3	Ensure 'allow-suspicious-udfs' is Set to 'OFF' (Automated)	☐	☐

CIS Benchmark Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
4.4	Harden Usage for 'local_infile' on MySQL Clients (Automated)	☐	☐
4.5	Ensure 'mysqld' is Not Started With '--skip-grant-tables' (Automated)	☐	☐
4.6	Ensure Symbolic Links are Disabled (Automated)	☐	☐
4.7	Ensure the 'secure_file_priv' is Configured Correctly (Automated)	☐	☐
4.8	Ensure 'sql_mode' Contains 'STRICT_ALL_TABLES' (Automated)	☐	☐
4.9	Use MySQL TDE for at rest data encryption (Automated)	☐	☐
5	MySQL Permissions		
5.1	Ensure Only Administrative Users Have Full Database Access (Manual)	☐	☐
5.2	Ensure 'FILE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users (Manual)	☐	☐
5.3	Ensure 'PROCESS' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users (Manual)	☐	☐
5.4	Ensure 'SUPER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users (Manual)	☐	☐
5.5	Ensure 'SHUTDOWN' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users (Manual)	☐	☐
5.6	Ensure 'CREATE USER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users (Manual)	☐	☐
5.7	Ensure 'GRANT OPTION' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users (Manual)	☐	☐
5.8	Ensure 'REPLICATION SLAVE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users (Manual)	☐	☐

CIS Benchmark Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
5.9	Ensure DML/DDDL Grants are Limited to Specific Databases and Users (Manual)	☐	☐
5.10	Securely Define Stored Procedures and Functions DEFINER and INVOKER (Manual)	☐	☐
5.11	Ensure Proper Use Of 'SET_ANY_DEFINER' (Manual)	☐	☐
5.12	Ensure Proper Use Of 'ALLOW_NONEXISTENT_DEFINER' (Manual)	☐	☐
6	Auditing and Logging		
6.1	Ensure 'log_error' is configured correctly (Automated)	☐	☐
6.2	Ensure Log Files are Stored on a Non-System Partition (Automated)	☐	☐
6.3	Ensure 'log_error_verbosity' is Set to '2' (Automated)	☐	☐
6.4	Ensure 'log-raw' is Set to 'OFF' (Automated)	☐	☐
7	Authentication		
7.1	Ensure your 'authentication_policy' is Set to a Secure Option (Automated)	☐	☐
7.2	Ensure Passwords are Not Stored in the Global Configuration (Automated)	☐	☐
7.3	Ensure Passwords are Set for All MySQL Accounts (Automated)	☐	☐
7.4	Set 'default_password_lifetime' to Require a Yearly Password Change (Automated)	☐	☐
7.5	Ensure Password Complexity Policies are in Place (Automated)	☐	☐
7.6	Ensure No Users Have Wildcard Hostnames (Automated)	☐	☐

CIS Benchmark Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
7.7	Ensure No Anonymous Accounts Exist (Automated)	☐	☐
7.8	Ensure 'caching_sha2_password' uses and enforces 'PBKDF2-SHA512' password storage (Manual)	☐	☐
7.9	Ensure 'activate_all_roles_on_login' is disabled and mandatory role activation is explicitly controlled (Manual)	☐	☐
8	Network		
8.1	Ensure 'require_secure_transport' is set to 'ON' (Automated)	☐	☐
8.2	Ensure 'ssl_type' is set to 'X509' or 'SPECIFIED' for all remote users (Automated)	☐	☐
8.3	Set Maximum Connection Limits for Server and per User (Manual)	☐	☐
9	Replication		
9.1	Ensure Replication Traffic is Secured (Manual)	☐	☐
9.2	Ensure 'SOURCE_SSL_VERIFY_SERVER_CERT' is Set to 'YES' or '1' (Automated)	☐	☐
9.3	Ensure 'super_priv' is Not Set to 'Y' for Replication Users (Automated)	☐	☐
10	MySQL InnoDB Cluster / Group Replication		
10.1	Ensure All Group Replication Traffic is Secured (Manual)	☐	☐
10.2	Allowlist Approved Servers Belonging to a MySQL InnoDB Cluster (Manual)	☐	☐

Appendix: CIS Controls v7 IG 1 Mapped Recommendations

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
1.3	Disable MySQL Command History	☐	☐
1.5	Ensure Interactive Login is Disabled	☐	☐
2.1.1	Backup Policy in Place	☐	☐
2.1.3	Secure Backup Credentials	☐	☐
2.1.4	The Backups Should be Properly Secured	☐	☐
2.1.5	Point-in-Time Recovery	☐	☐
2.1.7	Backup of Configuration and Related Files	☐	☐
2.5	Do Not Reuse Usernames	☐	☐
2.11	Lock Out Accounts if Not Currently in Use	☐	☐
3.1	Ensure 'datadir' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.2	Ensure 'log_bin_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.3	Ensure 'log_error' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.4	Ensure 'slow_query_log' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.5	Ensure 'relay_log_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.6	Ensure 'general_log_file' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.7	Ensure SSL Key Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.8	Ensure Plugin Directory Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
4.1	Ensure the Latest Security Patches are Applied	☐	☐
4.5	Ensure 'mysqld' is Not Started With '--skip-grant-tables'	☐	☐
5.1	Ensure Only Administrative Users Have Full Database Access	☐	☐
5.2	Ensure 'FILE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.3	Ensure 'PROCESS' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.4	Ensure 'SUPER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
5.5	Ensure 'SHUTDOWN' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.6	Ensure 'CREATE USER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.7	Ensure 'GRANT OPTION' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.8	Ensure 'REPLICATION SLAVE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.9	Ensure DML/DDDL Grants are Limited to Specific Databases and Users	☐	☐
5.10	Securely Define Stored Procedures and Functions DEFINER and INVOKER	☐	☐
5.11	Ensure Proper Use Of 'SET_ANY_DEFINER'	☐	☐
5.12	Ensure Proper Use Of 'ALLOW_NONEXISTENT_DEFINER'	☐	☐
6.1	Ensure 'log_error' is configured correctly	☐	☐
6.4	Ensure 'log-raw' is Set to 'OFF'	☐	☐
7.6	Ensure No Users Have Wildcard Hostnames	☐	☐

Appendix: CIS Controls v7 IG 2 Mapped Recommendations

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
1.3	Disable MySQL Command History	☐	☐
1.4	Verify That the MYSQL_PWD Environment Variable is Not in Use	☐	☐
1.5	Ensure Interactive Login is Disabled	☐	☐
1.6	Verify That 'MYSQL_PWD' is Not Set in Users' Profiles	☐	☐
2.1.1	Backup Policy in Place	☐	☐
2.1.2	Verify Backups are Good	☐	☐
2.1.3	Secure Backup Credentials	☐	☐
2.1.4	The Backups Should be Properly Secured	☐	☐
2.1.5	Point-in-Time Recovery	☐	☐
2.1.7	Backup of Configuration and Related Files	☐	☐
2.4	Do Not Specify Passwords in the Command Line	☐	☐
2.5	Do Not Reuse Usernames	☐	☐
2.6	Ensure Non-Default, Unique Cryptographic Material is in Use	☐	☐
2.7	Ensure 'password_lifetime' is Less Than or Equal to '365'	☐	☐
2.9	Require Current Password for Password Reset	☐	☐
2.10	Use Dual Passwords to Enable Higher Frequency Password Rotation	☐	☐
2.11	Lock Out Accounts if Not Currently in Use	☐	☐
2.12	Ensure AES Encryption Mode for AES_ENCRYPT/AES_DECRYPT is Configured Correctly	☐	☐
2.15	Limit Accepted Transport Layer Security (TLS) Versions	☐	☐
2.16	Require Client-Side Certificates (X.509)	☐	☐
2.17	Ensure Only Approved Ciphers are Used	☐	☐
2.19	Ensure FIPS 140-3 OpenSSL Cryptography Is Used	☐	☐
3.1	Ensure 'datadir' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
3.2	Ensure 'log_bin_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.3	Ensure 'log_error' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.4	Ensure 'slow_query_log' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.5	Ensure 'relay_log_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.6	Ensure 'general_log_file' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.7	Ensure SSL Key Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.8	Ensure Plugin Directory Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
4.1	Ensure the Latest Security Patches are Applied	☐	☐
4.4	Harden Usage for 'local_infile' on MySQL Clients	☐	☐
4.5	Ensure 'mysqld' is Not Started With '--skip-grant-tables'	☐	☐
5.1	Ensure Only Administrative Users Have Full Database Access	☐	☐
5.2	Ensure 'FILE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.3	Ensure 'PROCESS' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.4	Ensure 'SUPER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.5	Ensure 'SHUTDOWN' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.6	Ensure 'CREATE USER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.7	Ensure 'GRANT OPTION' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.8	Ensure 'REPLICATION SLAVE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.9	Ensure DML/DDL Grants are Limited to Specific Databases and Users	☐	☐
5.10	Securely Define Stored Procedures and Functions DEFINER and INVOKER	☐	☐
5.11	Ensure Proper Use Of 'SET ANY DEFINER'	☐	☐
5.12	Ensure Proper Use Of 'ALLOW_NONEXISTENT_DEFINER'	☐	☐

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
6.1	Ensure 'log_error' is configured correctly	☐	☐
6.2	Ensure Log Files are Stored on a Non-System Partition	☐	☐
6.3	Ensure 'log_error_verbosity' is Set to '2'	☐	☐
6.4	Ensure 'log-raw' is Set to 'OFF'	☐	☐
7.1	Ensure your 'authentication_policy' is Set to a Secure Option	☐	☐
7.2	Ensure Passwords are Not Stored in the Global Configuration	☐	☐
7.3	Ensure Passwords are Set for All MySQL Accounts	☐	☐
7.4	Set 'default_password_lifetime' to Require a Yearly Password Change	☐	☐
7.5	Ensure Password Complexity Policies are in Place	☐	☐
7.6	Ensure No Users Have Wildcard Hostnames	☐	☐
7.7	Ensure No Anonymous Accounts Exist	☐	☐
7.8	Ensure 'caching_sha2_password' uses and enforces 'PBKDF2-SHA512' password storage	☐	☐
7.9	Ensure 'activate_all_roles_on_login' is disabled and mandatory role activation is explicitly controlled	☐	☐
8.1	Ensure 'require_secure_transport' is set to 'ON'	☐	☐
8.2	Ensure 'ssl_type' is set to 'X509' or 'SPECIFIED' for all remote users	☐	☐
9.1	Ensure Replication Traffic is Secured	☐	☐
10.1	Ensure All Group Replication Traffic is Secured	☐	☐

Appendix: CIS Controls v7 IG 3 Mapped Recommendations

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
1.1	Place Databases on Non-System Partitions	☐	☐
1.3	Disable MySQL Command History	☐	☐
1.4	Verify That the MYSQL_PWD Environment Variable is Not in Use	☐	☐
1.5	Ensure Interactive Login is Disabled	☐	☐
1.6	Verify That 'MYSQL_PWD' is Not Set in Users' Profiles	☐	☐
1.7	Ensure MySQL is Run Under a Sandbox Environment	☐	☐
2.1.1	Backup Policy in Place	☐	☐
2.1.2	Verify Backups are Good	☐	☐
2.1.3	Secure Backup Credentials	☐	☐
2.1.4	The Backups Should be Properly Secured	☐	☐
2.1.5	Point-in-Time Recovery	☐	☐
2.1.7	Backup of Configuration and Related Files	☐	☐
2.2.1	Ensure Binary and Relay Logs are Encrypted	☐	☐
2.3	Dedicate the Machine Running MySQL	☐	☐
2.4	Do Not Specify Passwords in the Command Line	☐	☐
2.5	Do Not Reuse Usernames	☐	☐
2.6	Ensure Non-Default, Unique Cryptographic Material is in Use	☐	☐
2.7	Ensure 'password_lifetime' is Less Than or Equal to '365'	☐	☐
2.9	Require Current Password for Password Reset	☐	☐
2.10	Use Dual Passwords to Enable Higher Frequency Password Rotation	☐	☐
2.11	Lock Out Accounts if Not Currently in Use	☐	☐
2.12	Ensure AES Encryption Mode for AES_ENCRYPT/AES_DECRYPT is Configured Correctly	☐	☐
2.15	Limit Accepted Transport Layer Security (TLS) Versions	☐	☐
2.16	Require Client-Side Certificates (X.509)	☐	☐

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
2.17	Ensure Only Approved Ciphers are Used	☐	☐
2.19	Ensure FIPS 140-3 OpenSSL Cryptography Is Used	☐	☐
3.1	Ensure 'datadir' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.2	Ensure 'log_bin_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.3	Ensure 'log_error' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.4	Ensure 'slow_query_log' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.5	Ensure 'relay_log_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.6	Ensure 'general_log_file' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.7	Ensure SSL Key Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.8	Ensure Plugin Directory Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
4.1	Ensure the Latest Security Patches are Applied	☐	☐
4.4	Harden Usage for 'local_infile' on MySQL Clients	☐	☐
4.5	Ensure 'mysqld' is Not Started With '--skip-grant-tables'	☐	☐
4.9	Use MySQL TDE for at rest data encryption	☐	☐
5.1	Ensure Only Administrative Users Have Full Database Access	☐	☐
5.2	Ensure 'FILE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.3	Ensure 'PROCESS' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.4	Ensure 'SUPER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.5	Ensure 'SHUTDOWN' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.6	Ensure 'CREATE USER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.7	Ensure 'GRANT OPTION' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.8	Ensure 'REPLICATION SLAVE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.9	Ensure DML/DDI Grants are Limited to Specific Databases and Users	☐	☐

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
5.10	Securely Define Stored Procedures and Functions DEFINER and INVOKER	☐	☐
5.11	Ensure Proper Use Of 'SET_ANY_DEFINER'	☐	☐
5.12	Ensure Proper Use Of 'ALLOW_NONEXISTENT_DEFINER'	☐	☐
6.1	Ensure 'log_error' is configured correctly	☐	☐
6.2	Ensure Log Files are Stored on a Non-System Partition	☐	☐
6.3	Ensure 'log_error_verbosity' is Set to '2'	☐	☐
6.4	Ensure 'log-raw' is Set to 'OFF'	☐	☐
7.1	Ensure your 'authentication_policy' is Set to a Secure Option	☐	☐
7.2	Ensure Passwords are Not Stored in the Global Configuration	☐	☐
7.3	Ensure Passwords are Set for All MySQL Accounts	☐	☐
7.4	Set 'default_password_lifetime' to Require a Yearly Password Change	☐	☐
7.5	Ensure Password Complexity Policies are in Place	☐	☐
7.6	Ensure No Users Have Wildcard Hostnames	☐	☐
7.7	Ensure No Anonymous Accounts Exist	☐	☐
7.8	Ensure 'caching_sha2_password' uses and enforces 'PBKDF2-SHA512' password storage	☐	☐
7.9	Ensure 'activate_all_roles_on_login' is disabled and mandatory role activation is explicitly controlled	☐	☐
8.1	Ensure 'require_secure_transport' is set to 'ON'	☐	☐
8.2	Ensure 'ssl_type' is set to 'X509' or 'SPECIFIED' for all remote users	☐	☐
9.1	Ensure Replication Traffic is Secured	☐	☐
10.1	Ensure All Group Replication Traffic is Secured	☐	☐

Appendix: CIS Controls v7 Unmapped Recommendations

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
2.8	Ensure Password Resets Require Strong Passwords	☐	☐
2.13	Ensure Socket Peer-Credential Authentication is Used Appropriately	☐	☐
2.14	Ensure MySQL is Bound to an IP Address	☐	☐
4.2	Ensure Example or Test Databases are Not Installed on Production Servers	☐	☐
4.3	Ensure 'allow-suspicious-udfs' is Set to 'OFF'	☐	☐
4.8	Ensure 'sql_mode' Contains 'STRICT_ALL_TABLES'	☐	☐
8.3	Set Maximum Connection Limits for Server and per User	☐	☐
9.2	Ensure 'SOURCE_SSL_VERIFY_SERVER_CERT' is Set to 'YES' or '1'	☐	☐
10.2	Allowlist Approved Servers Belonging to a MySQL InnoDB Cluster	☐	☐

Appendix: CIS Controls v8 IG 1 Mapped Recommendations

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
1.2	Use Dedicated Least Privileged Account for MySQL Daemon/Service	☐	☐
1.3	Disable MySQL Command History	☐	☐
1.5	Ensure Interactive Login is Disabled	☐	☐
2.1.1	Backup Policy in Place	☐	☐
2.1.3	Secure Backup Credentials	☐	☐
2.1.4	The Backups Should be Properly Secured	☐	☐
2.1.5	Point-in-Time Recovery	☐	☐
2.1.6	Disaster Recovery (DR) Plan	☐	☐
2.1.7	Backup of Configuration and Related Files	☐	☐
2.5	Do Not Reuse Usernames	☐	☐
2.8	Ensure Password Resets Require Strong Passwords	☐	☐
2.9	Require Current Password for Password Reset	☐	☐
2.10	Use Dual Passwords to Enable Higher Frequency Password Rotation	☐	☐
2.11	Lock Out Accounts if Not Currently in Use	☐	☐
3.1	Ensure 'datadir' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.2	Ensure 'log_bin_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.3	Ensure 'log_error' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.4	Ensure 'slow_query_log' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.5	Ensure 'relay_log_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.6	Ensure 'general_log_file' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.7	Ensure SSL Key Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.8	Ensure Plugin Directory Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
4.1	Ensure the Latest Security Patches are Applied	☐	☐
4.5	Ensure 'mysqld' is Not Started With '--skip-grant-tables'	☐	☐

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
4.7	Ensure the 'secure_file_priv' is Configured Correctly	☐	☐
5.1	Ensure Only Administrative Users Have Full Database Access	☐	☐
5.2	Ensure 'FILE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.3	Ensure 'PROCESS' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.4	Ensure 'SUPER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.5	Ensure 'SHUTDOWN' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.6	Ensure 'CREATE USER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.7	Ensure 'GRANT OPTION' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.8	Ensure 'REPLICATION SLAVE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.9	Ensure DML/DDL Grants are Limited to Specific Databases and Users	☐	☐
6.1	Ensure 'log_error' is configured correctly	☐	☐
6.2	Ensure Log Files are Stored on a Non-System Partition	☐	☐
6.4	Ensure 'log_raw' is Set to 'OFF'	☐	☐
7.1	Ensure your 'authentication_policy' is Set to a Secure Option	☐	☐
7.3	Ensure Passwords are Set for All MySQL Accounts	☐	☐
7.5	Ensure Password Complexity Policies are in Place	☐	☐
7.6	Ensure No Users Have Wildcard Hostnames	☐	☐
7.7	Ensure No Anonymous Accounts Exist	☐	☐
7.8	Ensure 'caching_sha2_password' uses and enforces 'PBKDF2-SHA512' password storage	☐	☐
9.3	Ensure 'super_priv' is Not Set to 'Y' for Replication Users	☐	☐
10.2	Allowlist Approved Servers Belonging to a MySQL InnoDB Cluster	☐	☐

Appendix: CIS Controls v8 IG 2 Mapped Recommendations

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
1.1	Place Databases on Non-System Partitions	☐	☐
1.2	Use Dedicated Least Privileged Account for MySQL Daemon/Service	☐	☐
1.3	Disable MySQL Command History	☐	☐
1.4	Verify That the MYSQL_PWD Environment Variable is Not in Use	☐	☐
1.5	Ensure Interactive Login is Disabled	☐	☐
1.6	Verify That 'MYSQL_PWD' is Not Set in Users' Profiles	☐	☐
1.7	Ensure MySQL is Run Under a Sandbox Environment	☐	☐
2.1.1	Backup Policy in Place	☐	☐
2.1.2	Verify Backups are Good	☐	☐
2.1.3	Secure Backup Credentials	☐	☐
2.1.4	The Backups Should be Properly Secured	☐	☐
2.1.5	Point-in-Time Recovery	☐	☐
2.1.6	Disaster Recovery (DR) Plan	☐	☐
2.1.7	Backup of Configuration and Related Files	☐	☐
2.2.1	Ensure Binary and Relay Logs are Encrypted	☐	☐
2.3	Dedicate the Machine Running MySQL	☐	☐
2.4	Do Not Specify Passwords in the Command Line	☐	☐
2.5	Do Not Reuse Usernames	☐	☐
2.6	Ensure Non-Default, Unique Cryptographic Material is in Use	☐	☐
2.8	Ensure Password Resets Require Strong Passwords	☐	☐
2.9	Require Current Password for Password Reset	☐	☐
2.10	Use Dual Passwords to Enable Higher Frequency Password Rotation	☐	☐
2.11	Lock Out Accounts if Not Currently in Use	☐	☐

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
2.12	Ensure AES Encryption Mode for AES_ENCRYPT/AES_DECRYPT is Configured Correctly	☐	☐
2.13	Ensure Socket Peer-Credential Authentication is Used Appropriately	☐	☐
2.14	Ensure MySQL is Bound to an IP Address	☐	☐
2.15	Limit Accepted Transport Layer Security (TLS) Versions	☐	☐
2.16	Require Client-Side Certificates (X.509)	☐	☐
2.17	Ensure Only Approved Ciphers are Used	☐	☐
2.19	Ensure FIPS 140-3 OpenSSL Cryptography Is Used	☐	☐
3.1	Ensure 'datadir' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.2	Ensure 'log_bin_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.3	Ensure 'log_error' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.4	Ensure 'slow_query_log' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.5	Ensure 'relay_log_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.6	Ensure 'general_log_file' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.7	Ensure SSL Key Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.8	Ensure Plugin Directory Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
4.1	Ensure the Latest Security Patches are Applied	☐	☐
4.2	Ensure Example or Test Databases are Not Installed on Production Servers	☐	☐
4.3	Ensure 'allow-suspicious-udfs' is Set to 'OFF'	☐	☐
4.4	Harden Usage for 'local_infile' on MySQL Clients	☐	☐
4.5	Ensure 'mysqld' is Not Started With '--skip-grant-tables'	☐	☐
4.6	Ensure Symbolic Links are Disabled	☐	☐
4.7	Ensure the 'secure_file_priv' is Configured Correctly	☐	☐
4.8	Ensure 'sql_mode' Contains 'STRICT_ALL_TABLES'	☐	☐
4.9	Use MySQL TDE for at rest data encryption	☐	☐
5.1	Ensure Only Administrative Users Have Full Database Access	☐	☐
5.2	Ensure 'FILE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
5.3	Ensure 'PROCESS' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.4	Ensure 'SUPER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.5	Ensure 'SHUTDOWN' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.6	Ensure 'CREATE USER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.7	Ensure 'GRANT OPTION' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.8	Ensure 'REPLICATION SLAVE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.9	Ensure DML/DDL Grants are Limited to Specific Databases and Users	☐	☐
5.10	Securely Define Stored Procedures and Functions DEFINER and INVOKER	☐	☐
5.11	Ensure Proper Use Of 'SET_ANY_DEFINER'	☐	☐
5.12	Ensure Proper Use Of 'ALLOW_NONEXISTENT_DEFINER'	☐	☐
6.1	Ensure 'log_error' is configured correctly	☐	☐
6.2	Ensure Log Files are Stored on a Non-System Partition	☐	☐
6.3	Ensure 'log_error_verbosity' is Set to '2'	☐	☐
6.4	Ensure 'log-raw' is Set to 'OFF'	☐	☐
7.1	Ensure your 'authentication_policy' is Set to a Secure Option	☐	☐
7.2	Ensure Passwords are Not Stored in the Global Configuration	☐	☐
7.3	Ensure Passwords are Set for All MySQL Accounts	☐	☐
7.5	Ensure Password Complexity Policies are in Place	☐	☐
7.6	Ensure No Users Have Wildcard Hostnames	☐	☐
7.7	Ensure No Anonymous Accounts Exist	☐	☐
7.8	Ensure 'caching_sha2_password' uses and enforces 'PBKDF2-SHA512' password storage	☐	☐
7.9	Ensure 'activate_all_roles_on_login' is disabled and mandatory role activation is explicitly controlled	☐	☐

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
8.1	Ensure 'require_secure_transport' is set to 'ON'	☐	☐
8.2	Ensure 'ssl_type' is set to 'X509' or 'SPECIFIED' for all remote users	☐	☐
9.1	Ensure Replication Traffic is Secured	☐	☐
9.2	Ensure 'SOURCE_SSL_VERIFY_SERVER_CERT' is Set to 'YES' or '1'	☐	☐
9.3	Ensure 'super_priv' is Not Set to 'Y' for Replication Users	☐	☐
10.1	Ensure All Group Replication Traffic is Secured	☐	☐
10.2	Allowlist Approved Servers Belonging to a MySQL InnoDB Cluster	☐	☐

Appendix: CIS Controls v8 IG 3 Mapped Recommendations

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
1.1	Place Databases on Non-System Partitions	☐	☐
1.2	Use Dedicated Least Privileged Account for MySQL Daemon/Service	☐	☐
1.3	Disable MySQL Command History	☐	☐
1.4	Verify That the MYSQL_PWD Environment Variable is Not in Use	☐	☐
1.5	Ensure Interactive Login is Disabled	☐	☐
1.6	Verify That 'MYSQL_PWD' is Not Set in Users' Profiles	☐	☐
1.7	Ensure MySQL is Run Under a Sandbox Environment	☐	☐
2.1.1	Backup Policy in Place	☐	☐
2.1.2	Verify Backups are Good	☐	☐
2.1.3	Secure Backup Credentials	☐	☐
2.1.4	The Backups Should be Properly Secured	☐	☐
2.1.5	Point-in-Time Recovery	☐	☐
2.1.6	Disaster Recovery (DR) Plan	☐	☐
2.1.7	Backup of Configuration and Related Files	☐	☐
2.2.1	Ensure Binary and Relay Logs are Encrypted	☐	☐
2.3	Dedicate the Machine Running MySQL	☐	☐
2.4	Do Not Specify Passwords in the Command Line	☐	☐
2.5	Do Not Reuse Usernames	☐	☐
2.6	Ensure Non-Default, Unique Cryptographic Material is in Use	☐	☐
2.8	Ensure Password Resets Require Strong Passwords	☐	☐
2.9	Require Current Password for Password Reset	☐	☐
2.10	Use Dual Passwords to Enable Higher Frequency Password Rotation	☐	☐
2.11	Lock Out Accounts if Not Currently in Use	☐	☐

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
2.12	Ensure AES Encryption Mode for AES_ENCRYPT/AES_DECRYPT is Configured Correctly	☐	☐
2.13	Ensure Socket Peer-Credential Authentication is Used Appropriately	☐	☐
2.14	Ensure MySQL is Bound to an IP Address	☐	☐
2.15	Limit Accepted Transport Layer Security (TLS) Versions	☐	☐
2.16	Require Client-Side Certificates (X.509)	☐	☐
2.17	Ensure Only Approved Ciphers are Used	☐	☐
2.19	Ensure FIPS 140-3 OpenSSL Cryptography Is Used	☐	☐
3.1	Ensure 'datadir' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.2	Ensure 'log_bin_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.3	Ensure 'log_error' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.4	Ensure 'slow_query_log' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.5	Ensure 'relay_log_basename' Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.6	Ensure 'general_log_file' Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.7	Ensure SSL Key Files Have Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
3.8	Ensure Plugin Directory Has Appropriate Permissions	☐	☐
4.1	Ensure the Latest Security Patches are Applied	☐	☐
4.2	Ensure Example or Test Databases are Not Installed on Production Servers	☐	☐
4.3	Ensure 'allow-suspicious-udfs' is Set to 'OFF'	☐	☐
4.4	Harden Usage for 'local_infile' on MySQL Clients	☐	☐
4.5	Ensure 'mysqld' is Not Started With '--skip-grant-tables'	☐	☐
4.6	Ensure Symbolic Links are Disabled	☐	☐
4.7	Ensure the 'secure_file_priv' is Configured Correctly	☐	☐
4.8	Ensure 'sql_mode' Contains 'STRICT_ALL_TABLES'	☐	☐
4.9	Use MySQL TDE for at rest data encryption	☐	☐
5.1	Ensure Only Administrative Users Have Full Database Access	☐	☐
5.2	Ensure 'FILE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
5.3	Ensure 'PROCESS' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.4	Ensure 'SUPER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.5	Ensure 'SHUTDOWN' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.6	Ensure 'CREATE USER' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.7	Ensure 'GRANT OPTION' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.8	Ensure 'REPLICATION SLAVE' is Not Granted to Non-Administrative Users	☐	☐
5.9	Ensure DML/DDL Grants are Limited to Specific Databases and Users	☐	☐
5.10	Securely Define Stored Procedures and Functions DEFINER and INVOKER	☐	☐
5.11	Ensure Proper Use Of 'SET_ANY_DEFINER'	☐	☐
5.12	Ensure Proper Use Of 'ALLOW_NONEXISTENT_DEFINER'	☐	☐
6.1	Ensure 'log_error' is configured correctly	☐	☐
6.2	Ensure Log Files are Stored on a Non-System Partition	☐	☐
6.3	Ensure 'log_error_verbosity' is Set to '2'	☐	☐
6.4	Ensure 'log-raw' is Set to 'OFF'	☐	☐
7.1	Ensure your 'authentication_policy' is Set to a Secure Option	☐	☐
7.2	Ensure Passwords are Not Stored in the Global Configuration	☐	☐
7.3	Ensure Passwords are Set for All MySQL Accounts	☐	☐
7.5	Ensure Password Complexity Policies are in Place	☐	☐
7.6	Ensure No Users Have Wildcard Hostnames	☐	☐
7.7	Ensure No Anonymous Accounts Exist	☐	☐
7.8	Ensure 'caching_sha2_password' uses and enforces 'PBKDF2-SHA512' password storage	☐	☐
7.9	Ensure 'activate_all_roles_on_login' is disabled and mandatory role activation is explicitly controlled	☐	☐

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
8.1	Ensure 'require_secure_transport' is set to 'ON'	☐	☐
8.2	Ensure 'ssl_type' is set to 'X509' or 'SPECIFIED' for all remote users	☐	☐
9.1	Ensure Replication Traffic is Secured	☐	☐
9.2	Ensure 'SOURCE_SSL_VERIFY_SERVER_CERT' is Set to 'YES' or '1'	☐	☐
9.3	Ensure 'super_priv' is Not Set to 'Y' for Replication Users	☐	☐
10.1	Ensure All Group Replication Traffic is Secured	☐	☐
10.2	Allowlist Approved Servers Belonging to a MySQL InnoDB Cluster	☐	☐

Appendix: CIS Controls v8 Unmapped Recommendations

Recommendation		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
8.3	Set Maximum Connection Limits for Server and per User	☐	☐

Appendix: Change History

Date	Version	Changes for this version
30 Jun 2026	1.0.0	Initial Release